

Block

2

RADIO AND TV JOURNALISM

UNIT 5

Writing for Radio

UNIT 6

Writing for TV

UNIT 7

Content Production for Radio & TV

UNIT 8

Presentation Techniques for Radio & TV



UNIT 5 WRITING FOR RADIO

Structure

- 5.0 Introduction
- 5.1 Learning Outcomes
- 5.2 Radio Writing – Challenges of the Medium
- 5.3 Basic Elements of Radio
- 5.4 Difference between Language of Print and Radio
- 5.5 Radio Writing for Different Radio Formats
- 5.6 Radio Writing – Broad Categories of Programmes
 - 5.6.1 Information Based Programmes
 - 5.6.2 Awareness Based Programmes
 - 5.6.3 Entertainment Based Programmes
- 5.7 Identifying the Listeners
- 5.8 Research for a Script
 - 5.8.1 Example of a Documentary
- 5.9 Attractive Beginning
 - 5.9.1 Examples of Attractive Beginning
 - 5.9.2 Maintaining the Flow of Script
 - 5.9.3 Precautions for Final Draft
- 5.10 Let Us Sum Up
- 5.11 References and Further Readings
- 5.12 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

5.0 INTRODUCTION

You have already understood the medium of radio and its basic characteristics. You have also acquainted yourself with the constraints and strengths of this medium. Radio writing simply means writing in the language of radio, so now we shall try to understand what is meant by the language of radio.

Radio writing is different from any other kind of writing. It is also true that radio writing is more difficult and challenging than other kinds of writing. This is so because radio is an aural medium. Further, even if we know the fundamentals of the appropriate language for radio, the creative challenges for writing still persist. The language for children's programme cannot be the same as that of a youth programme; and the language for rural programme will be entirely different than the language of any literary programme. Another issue is the absolute necessity to remain within the time duration allotted for the programme. Moreover, you have to deliver a powerful message or convince the audience about a product through spoken words only. The writing also varies according to the format. The craft of writing a talk will be entirely different from writing a radio play. Keeping all these things in mind, we shall try to learn some basic characteristics of radio writing in this unit.

5.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After reading this unit, you should be able to:

- differentiate between the languages of print and radio;
 - recall the main elements that constitute language of radio;
 - identify different forms of radio programmes;
 - distinguish between different formats of radio programmes; and
 - describe different stages of radio writing.
-

5.2 RADIO WRITING - CHALLENGES OF THE MEDIUM

Although you have understood the basic nature of radio as a medium, it is necessary to know certain essential facts before we venture into radio writing.

If you go to watch a movie in a cinema hall, you purchase a ticket and keep sitting in the darkness, not doing anything else except watching the movie. Similarly, while reading a book it is essential to devote your whole attention to the reading process. But, just imagine how many of us listen to radio while doing nothing else. Most of the radio listeners are engaged in some other simultaneous activities as well.

While listening to radio, someone may be driving a car, a housewife may be cooking in the kitchen, a student may be solving a mathematics problem, a farmer may be tilling his land, a shopkeeper may be attending to his customers and so on. Therefore, the radio writer has to shoulder a double responsibility. Firstly, from the very beginning of the programme, by sheer magic of his/her words he/she has to attract the listeners towards the programme, and, after that keep them engaged in it till the end. Further, the content of a radio programme has to be understood by the listeners then and there, in real time, during the process of listening itself. While reading a book or a magazine, the meaning of a difficult word can be looked up in a dictionary and to clarify a point or doubt one can go back to the earlier passage. But, this is not possible while listening to radio. Hence in radio writing there is no scope for difficult words, long sentences, unknown references etc. A radio script has to be in a language we use to speak or talk to each other. That is why the language of radio script is called 'Spoken Word'. It should be friendly and informal. Another challenge for a radio writer is the wide diversity of listeners – from scholarly intellectuals to illiterates - so a radio writer has to find a balance in his writing so that it can appeal to a wide spectrum of society.

5.3 BASIC ELEMENTS OF RADIO

Every Radio programme is in fact a message to the listeners. If this message is communicated to and understood by the listeners and also appreciated, then that radio writing can be considered effective and fruitful. A message through radio or any other medium, have certain codes from the sender of the message and one who receives the message decodes them. Let us understand this by some simple examples.

When we talk to each other, then the codes which work to deliver the message are:

- Spoken words
- Facial expressions
- Body gestures such as hand movements

The person to whom we are talking decodes, i.e. understands these. For instance, just by staring sternly, a father can convey his anger or disapproval to his child. A professor can stop a student coming late to the class just by a movement of his hand.

In the print medium, i.e. books, magazines, newspapers etc., written words, pictures, tables, graphs etc. work as ‘codes’ to take the message to the readers. Now, let us try to understand the codes which work for a radio message, i.e. the basic elements which create the ‘language of radio’. As you have learnt in Unit 1, there are four basic elements which constitute radio programmes, i.e. whenever we listen to any programme of any radio station from any part of the world, we shall hear only these four:

- Spoken words
- Sound effects
- Music
- Pause or Silence

Words are the most important part of any radio programme. These words are different from printed words because they reach a listener through a ‘human voice’ and thus are ‘spoken words’. Words of radio form a double code. One, their own meaning embellished by the beauty of language and second, the voice in which these are rendered. Thus, the quality of voice as well as delivery of words can make the language of radio more effective, depending on the style of presentation. In brief we may say that:

- i) Words used in a radio programme are spoken words.
- ii) These give a feel of human presence.
- iii) These also reflect some aspects of the speaker’s personality.
- iv) These may tell us about the ‘broadcast stations’ or even the country from where the broadcast is coming.

Because radio is a blind medium with no visuals, appropriate sound effects enrich the visuals created by spoken words in listeners’ minds. Radio plays and documentaries take immense help from suitable sound effects. Music also helps in developing the language of radio. For example, a musical piece of just 30 seconds, which is played as a ‘signature tune’, identifies not only the broadcast institution but also the individual programme. Similarly, the effect of an opening or dropping curtain in a theatre is achieved by ‘fade in’ and ‘fade out’ of music in a radio drama. The background music in a radio drama is helpful in making a scene lively.

Radio is a sound medium but absence of any sound is also an important part of language of radio. This really is the most interesting contradiction that no radio programme can be imagined without natural and even deliberate pauses or

silences. Pause is an integral part of the grammar of radio. The use of a comma or full stop in print is replaced by that of a pause in radio.

5.4 DIFFERENCE BETWEEN LANGUAGE OF PRINT AND RADIO

Having understood the basics of radio language as a spoken language, we can now very well understand the difference between languages of print and radio. Sometimes experts invited for broadcast don't understand the requirements of radio and bring a script designed more for the print media, i.e. using the characteristics of 'written word' and not 'spoken word'. Let us try to understand the delicate difference through some examples.

In a newspaper if we read an article we may find – 'we should take the precautions mentioned below'. Likewise we may say 'the above facts are important' in an article. However, as there is no 'below' or 'above' in spoken language, using similar phrases in a radio talk will sound ridiculous. Again, instead of mentioning dates in radio, the use of 'yesterday', 'day before yesterday' or 'last week' or 'last month' etc. may be better suited as spoken language.

In radio, we try to paint a picture through spoken words as radio is a blind medium. Hence, if we say that the height of Bhakra Dam is 740 feet, it may not conjure a picture. But, if we say that Bhakra Dam is as high as three Qutub Minars put one above the other, then it will make a visual impact in the mind of a listener. We may also say that the height of Qutub Minar is the same as 125 people standing on one above the other. It again creates a visual.

Similarly in print we may say that the capitals of Japan, Malaysia and Indonesia are Tokyo, Kuala Lumpur and Jakarta respectively but in Radio it will be appropriate to say that Tokyo is the capital of Japan, Kuala Lumpur is Malaysia's capital and Jakarta is the capital of Indonesia, thus avoiding the use of word 'respectively'. We avoid using complex and complicated sentences in radio language. Simple words and short sentences are the requirements of radio communication.

Likewise, while talking about history, instead of saying '1520 AD' it might be better to say approximately 500 years ago. Long figures such as 'Rupees 15 lakhs 53 thousands 9 hundred 74' may be better said as 'about 15 and half lakhs' or 'more than 15 lakhs'.

To summarise of what we learned in this part of the Unit, we can say that a radio listeners may be engaged in some other activities while listening to radio; therefore we should keep our words simple and friendly as in our normal conversation. Long and complicated sentences need to be avoided. Short sentences and simple words are essential requirements of radio language.

5.5 RADIO WRITING FOR DIFFERENT RADIO FORMATS

Just as poetry, short story, novels, drama, essays, travelogues etc. are different formats of literature, similarly there are many formats of radio programmes and these formats are created by combinations of the four elements of radio i.e. spoken

word, sound effect, music and pause. Pause is a compulsory element for all the formats. If we take only spoken words (no sound effect, no music), we get the following formats:

- 1) Radio Talk
- 2) Dialogue
- 3) Interview
- 4) Discussion
- 5) News Bulletin

If we combine spoken words with sound effects we have the following formats:

- 1) Quiz
- 2) Radio Report
- 3) Live Commentary

If we combine spoken words, sound effects and music, then we have:

- 1) Radio Feature/Documentary
- 2) Radio Drama
- 3) Radio Spots (Advertisements/commercials)
- 4) Radio Serial
- 5) Docudrama
- 6) Newsreel

Every Radio format has its own attraction and requirements. We choose a format as per available airtime, subject or theme, target audience, etc. Thus, while a radio advertisement may be of just 30 seconds duration, a radio play may be 15 minutes to 1 hour long, and a talk may usually be of 4 to 9 minutes. We have to understand a particular radio format before writing a script for it.

It has to be understood here that certain formats of radio programmes have to be unscripted by their very nature. For instance, running commentary of a sports or non-sports event cannot be pre-scripted as it is essentially a live description of what is happening on the spur of the moment. However, proper preparation and having detailed background material are indispensable for running commentaries also. Similarly, interviews and discussions are also extempore formats but systemically preparing talking points is essential for these, so that invaluable radio time is put to optimum use.

Activity – 1

Listen to different scripted radio formats like talks, plays, documentaries, etc. and then compare them with non scripted formats like interview or commentary.

5.6 RADIO WRITING – BROAD CATEGORIES OF PROGRAMMES

After understanding the language of radio, we should also be aware of the various fields for which radio writing can be done. We have a vast range of subjects for people of all age groups having varied interests. Broadcasting touches many

areas of our life and so the scope for radio writing becomes almost unlimited. It is, however, worth mentioning that, unlike AIR stations, private FM channels should not be taken as the representative model of a radio station. The main purpose of private radio channels is earning commercial revenue through mostly entertainment oriented programmes. They use not more than 3 to 4 programme formats out of more than 25 programme formats available to programme producers. Let us know in detail what kinds of programmes are broadcast from a radio station dedicated to public service broadcasting. That would make you familiar with the whole scenario of broadcasting. But, first we should know the three major functions or objectives of broadcasting, which result in three broad categories of programmes.

5.6.1 Information Based Programmes

From the very beginning, the first and foremost purpose of radio broadcasting has been to provide information to the listeners. Many informative programmes are broadcast every day from a majority of radio stations. News bulletins and programmes on current affairs are prime examples of this role played by radio. Although now there are hundreds of television channels and also social media platforms from where one get all sorts of information, the role of radio as the primary information disseminator to a wide spectrum of society continues to be relevant.

5.6.2 Awareness Based Programmes

To educate is the second most important function of radio. This is particularly true of broadcasting in India. Radio serves people by not only informing them about the latest happenings but also imparting education to them in a non-formal manner. Radio stations broadcast educational programmes for the listeners to supplement their knowledge.

There are millions of visually challenged people who cannot avail the benefits of print and visual media. Radio provides great service to these people by giving information and education, thus enabling them to lead a productive and dignified life. Radio has also done a great service by educating the farmers about the improved techniques of agriculture and opportunities for better marketing of their produce. It also helps the students' community by imparting them education of high quality.

5.6.3 Entertainment Based Programmes

Entertainment is the third most important activity of broadcasting. While there are multiple means of entertainment available for affluent people in larger cities, multitude of people still get a lot of their entertainment from radio programmes. In fact, a special service named 'Vividh Bharati' with a mix of film music and other light hearted programmes was created in 1957 by All India Radio to cater to the entertainment needs of millions of people all over the country. Now, FM channels of AIR namely FM Rainbow and FM Gold also serve the infotainment needs of the people

Private FM Channels function with a focus on entertainment, whereas AIR FM channels also devote airtime for information and education.

Check Your Progress: 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) How is Radio writing different from other media?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) What are the three broad categories of radio programmes?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

5.7 IDENTIFYING THE LISTENERS

After learning about the broad categories of programmes, radio writers should also know about the programmes for special audiences.

Whenever we plan a programme and write a script for it, we have to keep in mind the listeners of that programme. Certain programmes are for all the listeners but many are targeted at special groups of audience. When we write for a particular audience group, we also need to identify various sub-groups and their particular requirements. For example, radio stations have programmes for women but all women may not have identical interests. A housewife may have some requirements but a working woman may have different requirements. Similarly, needs of an unemployed youth would be different from those of a young person holding a good job.

5.8 RESEARCH FOR A SCRIPT

Any radio script can be effective on the basis of its content, which depends on the research about the subject. Let us take an example. If a talk on the historic Red Fort in Delhi, mentions about the fact that the road opposite Red Fort going to Chandni Chowk used to be a 'Canal' during the Mughal period, will certainly attract the attention of the listener. Listeners may like this information, which might be hitherto unknown to them that the road which is now brimming with heavy traffic is the place where people used to enjoy boating in the moonlight. To find out unknown, rare facts on a given subject, we should consult books on the subject, go through magazines for relevant articles, consult subject matter specialists, visit a particular place or tourist spot or historical building concerning the subject and so on. Formats like documentaries require deep and detailed

research. But, even for writing a radio talk of 5 minutes, the importance of research can't be ignored. If we write for radio without proper knowledge of facts, it will only be a 'play of words', which would be unethical and will almost mean cheating the listeners.

5.8.1 Example of a Documentary

Let us take a practical example to understand about the need of in-depth research for a format like a radio documentary. Suppose you have to write a script for a documentary on 'Suicides in India'. You will have to find out the average annual number of suicides in the country along with the data and information on various aspects such as tendency for suicide in different age groups, reasons for suicide, government efforts to prevent suicides, role of NGOs, society, family members, friends, etc. Information about the trends in other countries and preventive efforts made is also relevant.

For a documentary on 'Suicides in India' broadcast by All India Radio, the writer carried out the research by consulting psychologists, psychiatrists, sociologists, writers, social workers and government officials on various known and unknown aspects of suicide. He also consulted books research papers, magazines and internet. The writer also talked to those who had tried to commit suicide but survived. Legal experts and family members of those who committed suicide were also consulted. A number of lesser known facts emerged from the research like:

- India is among those countries of the world where large number of suicides take place. In India every 6 minutes someone commits suicide and 100 people attempt suicide every hour. The tendency to commit suicide is not confined to cities only, it has reached smaller cities, towns and even villages.
- Many children commit suicides due to increased pressure and expectations from family and schools. Many elderly people are also committing suicide due to depression and loneliness.
- Suicides indicate mental illness but mental health has not been given due attention in our country. People hesitate to go to a psychiatrist or counsellor due to the perceived stigma of being called insane.
- About 95% of the people contemplating suicide can be saved, if timely help can be offered to them and that 'vulnerable' moment can be avoided. In fact, the attempt to commit suicide is a 'cry for help'.

Now, you must have understood the importance of the research for a particular subject.

5.9 ATTRACTIVE BEGINNING

After you have done proper research on a subject and get down to write a script for radio, the most important aspect is an attractive beginning. You must have observed that newspapers often give very catchy, interesting and attention seeking headline to their news stories. For instance, there was a headline "Pak PM throws a no ball" making dramatic use of the fact of the Pakistani Prime Minister having been a well-known cricket bowler.

Attractive beginning is important for all the mass media but in a radio programme it is very crucial as this medium has no visual dimension like television or cinema and, hence, the opening few lines of a radio programme often decide the fate of the entire programme. In the case of television, someone may keep watching the programme because of a favourite actor or actress or a beautiful visual but the same is not true for radio. A very formal beginning of the radio programme has very little chance of being attractive. Whatever be the subject, the beginning should be such that it connects immediately with the listener, creates curiosity, touches emotions and forces the listener to pay attention and start listening to the programme.

5.9.1 Examples of Attractive Beginning

Suppose you have to write the script of a radio talk on environmental pollution. A traditional formal beginning for this could be:

“Pollution is a serious problem in India. There are mainly three kinds of pollution – air pollution, water pollution and sound pollution.....”

Such a beginning may not attract many listeners because of its formal tone. However, if you start the script in the following manner:

“Taj Mahal is the symbol of eternal love and one of the Seven Wonders of the World. But, are you aware that this gleaming white monument may become black one day? No, it is not just a horrible imagination; the increasing environmental pollution can make this a reality one day, if we don’t wake up now and start protecting our environment”...

Such a beginning is much more likely to catch the attention of the listeners because Taj Mahal touches a chord with every Indian, as it is a symbol of glory and also one of the prominent identities of India. Similarly if you have to write a talk or documentary on the Bheel tribe, a formal beginning might be like this:

“In India there are many tribes. Bheels are one such prominent tribe. They live mainly in Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh.....” Again such a formal opening may not appeal to many listeners. But to make the programme connect better with listeners, we have a number of other informal opening options.

- 1) We may begin with the story of ‘Eklavya’ who gave his ‘thumb’ to his ‘Guru’ (teacher) as ‘Gurudakshina’ or fee.
- 2) Story of ‘Shabri’ in Ramayan who offered fruits to Lord Ram after tasting them to check whether they were sweet enough.
- 3) Story of great warrior Maharana Pratap, who was given shelter by ‘Bheels’ in the forests when he was fighting the army of Akbar.

5.9.2 Maintaining the Flow of Script

An attractive beginning catches the attention of the audience and makes them listen to our programme, but that is not all. We have to ensure that our listener continues to listen to the whole programme with maximum possible attention. If after a good beginning, the writer is not able to maintain the flow and the progression of the script does not arouse any curiosity then the programme will not achieve its objective. Hence, it is necessary for a radio writer to ensure that along with the use of informal and friendly language, relevant and interesting

facts on the subject continue to be presented in an attractive manner so that the listener remains engrossed in the broadcast.

The talker may be a very renowned and knowledgeable person but while broadcasting he/she should use interactive phrases such as 'let us see why it happens' and 'you must be wondering why it is so' just to establish a friendly rapport with the listener and make them a partner in discussing the subject.

Basic rules of a Radio script:

- a) **Use simple words:** Easier simple and common words should be used. We need to remember how we talk, not how we write. Radio is a medium whose least common denominator audience are the laymen, using simple words is really important. A list of a few radio appropriate words in English is provided below. I am sure you can find such equivalents in your own mother tongue too:

Written	Spoken
Adequate	Enough
Anticipate	Expect
Commence	Begin, start
Conclude	End
Manufacture	Make
Purchase	Buy
Underprivileged	Poor

- b) **Use short sentences:** Sentences should avoid conjunctions as much as possible. The sentences should ideally be of a length appropriate for talking. Remember, unlike print we cannot go back to the sentence and rehear it.
- c) **One idea per sentence:** One sentence should carry one idea. Never clutter one sentence with too many ideas.
- d) **Avoid sound clashes:** Read your copy aloud for awkward sounds. Be sparing in the use of 's' 'th' and 'ing' sounds. Avoid words like 'thrust', 'wrists' and 'frisked' all of which are difficult to pronounce.
- e) **Use present tense:** This is especially relevant for news bulletins, particularly the headlines. For conveying the immediacy and to drive home the urgency of news, use of present tense is a cardinal rule. For example:
- The Monsoon Session **has commenced (commences).**
 - We **have responsibility** for quality..... **(are responsible).**
 - The Prime Minister **has inaugurated** the project **(inaugurates).**
- f) **Use active voice:** Scripts should be written in active voice, for example: - A new governor was **appointed by the President (President appointed).**
- Ten shops were **destroyed by a fire ... (A fire destroyed)**
 - A meeting will be held **by the teachers.... (Teachers will hold a)**

- g. Avoid stock phrases, superfluous words and clichés. Below is a tentative list of each word that we tend to use every day while writing in English (which is not exhaustive):

Stock Phrases:

“Lead from the front” – Where else?

“Follow in x’s foot steps”- just follow “Ground rules”- just rules

Superfluous words:

- Set a *new* record
- *Died* in a *fatal* accident Holiday *period*
- *Future* plans
- It is a *true* fact In a week’s *time* *First* priority *Past* History

5.9.3 Precautions for Final Draft

Once you have written and evaluated your script for a radio programme and found it suitable for broadcast, keep the following precautions in mind while preparing a final draft:

- 1) Script should be typed or written only on one side of a sheet so that no noise is recorded while turning the pages.
- 2) It is better to finish a paragraph on the same page. If that is not possible, at least, the sentence should be completed. Carrying an incomplete sentence on to the next page should be avoided because it will create a break in the flow of reading at the time of recording. A new page should always begin with a new sentence.
- 3) Nothing should be written which is against the code of conduct of the concerned broadcast organisation.
- 4) Decency of language should always be maintained.
- 5) Nothing should be written which can hurt the sentiments of any community or ridicule any disabled person even if it is a programme of humour or satire.

Check Your Progress: 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

- 1) What are the basic rules of writing a radio script?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

5.10 LET US SUM UP

Radio writing is different from writing for a magazine or a newspaper. While listening to a programme, it is not possible for a listener to go back and forth; therefore a radio broadcast has to be followed and understood by the listeners simultaneously in real time. Short sentences and simple language are essential for a radio script. For effective radio writing, the writer has to be mindful of the duration and format of the programme and also be aware of the target listener for whom the programme script is being written. The beginning of the programme should be very attractive and flow of language and content should be maintained till the end of the programme to sustain the interest of the listeners. Intelligent research about the subject is very important to make the programme rich in content.

5.11 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

- 1) Grove, C., & Wyatt, S. (2013). *So you want to write radio drama*. London: Nick Hern Books.
- 2) Horstmann, R. (1997). *Writing for radio*. London: A & C Black.
- 3) MacLoughlin, S. (2001). *Writing for radio*. Oxford: How To Books.

5.12 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) Radio is an audio medium and hence a radio script has to be written for the ear. It should be written in a conversant manner while using simple words and short sentences. Unlike the print, a listener cannot go back to re-hear a portion that is unclear. Also, there are no supporting visuals in radio like that in a television. So, care needs to be taken to make a script easily comprehensible.
- 2) The categories of radio programmes are as follows:
 - Programmes that inform – These provide information and news to the listeners.
 - Programmes that educate – These help educate. Several different educational programmes are broadcast for different segments of people students, farmers, etc.
 - Programmes that entertain – This has increasingly become one of the key radio functions. No one wants to hear anything boring and thus the increasing need for entertaining programmes.

Check Your Progress 2

- While writing a Radio script, you should: Use simple words and short sentences. Unlike print, a listener cannot go back and re-hear what's been said. So it is important to use words and sentences that will be easily understood in one go.
- Present one idea per sentence so as not to confuse the audience.
- Use active voice and present tense, as these make for simpler language that is easily understood.

UNIT 6 WRITING FOR TELEVISION

Structure

- 6.0 Introduction
- 6.1 Learning Outcomes
- 6.2 Television News Stories
 - 6.2.1 Chronology of Television News Content Creation
 - 6.2.2 Stages of Television News
- 6.3 Writing for Television News
 - 6.3.1 Basic Principles
 - 6.3.2 Fundamental Rules
 - 6.3.3 How to Write an Anchor-Package
 - 6.3.4 Writing News Feature and Documentary
- 6.4 Let Us Sum Up
- 6.5 Key Words
- 6.6 References and Further Readings
- 6.7 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

6.0 INTRODUCTION

Television (TV) has become an integral part of our lives these days as most of us depend on it for our daily dose of entertainment, news and information. Besides that often TV programmes in general, and TV news, in particular tend to influence our views thus indicating its possible impact on the society at large. Hence, the responsibility of TV news programme makers increases manifold. TV news writing is a critical part of those programmes and in this Unit, we shall try to understand various aspects of it. TV news programmes generally include news bulletins, news features, documentaries based on news, interviews, panel discussions and so on. So, writing for TV generally means writing scripts for news bulletins, features and documentaries as other formats such as interviews and panel discussions are not required to be scripted.

6.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After reading through this Unit, you will be able to:

- describe the various stages of television news;
- discuss the basic principles of television news writing;
- describe the fundamental rules for writing a good television news script; and
- understand the writing for different formats of television news.

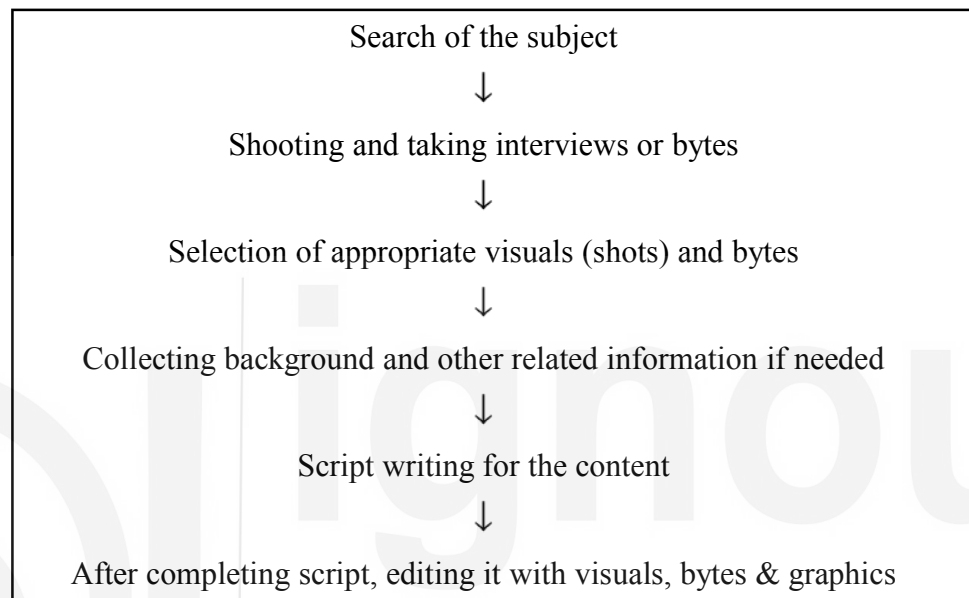
6.2 TELEVISION NEWS STORIES

Television channels broadcast news and current affairs related content in different programme formats. In this Unit, we shall focus mainly on the news stories.

Before going directly to the writing part, it is necessary to discuss the basic steps of production of a television news story. We shall also discuss the journey of a TV news story from its birth as *breaking news* to its matured stage of *anchor-package*. All these discussions will finally help us to improve our writing capabilities.

6.2.1 Chronology of Television News Content Creation

Television news content creation has a standard chronology. For writing an effective TV news script, you should understand it. The following chart shows this chronology:



This is the normal chronology which is followed to create news contents but in some cases the order may be changed. For example, in hardcore news segments, you get the raw information and may be asked to telecast the news as early as possible and therefore, you cannot plan your story according to the standard chronology.

6.2.2 Stages of Television News

There are various stages of a TV news and you should be aware of all of them. Writing is involved in almost all these stages at different levels. Many news pieces may not pass all the stages but unless you know all of them, you would not be able to decide which stage is fit for which news piece. Following are the stages of a TV news:

- Breaking News or Flash
- Dry Anchor Read
- Anchor-Live
- Anchor-Visuals
- Anchor-Byte
- Anchor- Package

Obviously for each stage, the process of writing will be different. For becoming a good TV journalist, it is necessary for you to know about all of them. We are going to give you a brief information about these stages of a television news.

Breaking News or Flash: When you receive an information from your source which has news value for your audience, you decide to present it as soon as possible. At this stage, the news will be of one or two lines. The purpose of the breaking news is to make your viewers aware of the latest happenings immediately. If you get some more information of the happening, you can break the news into small lines to present it.

Dry Anchor Read: Dry anchor read means that the anchor or news presenter reads the news only without any visuals. This normally happens in the case of breaking news situation. It can also be presented with graphics plates where the information is written on the screen.

Anchor-Live: If the news is in developing stage, the news bulletin producer may decide to take the live or telephonic interview of the reporter after anchor read. If visuals are available, they can be used along with 'live' or 'phone link' of the reporter.

Anchor-Visuals: When the news related visuals come into the newsroom, the anchor reads the news and the appropriate visuals are played over that. Here the purpose is to present the news in a concise manner.

Anchor-Byte: If there are some bytes relevant to the news item, it is also often attached with the anchor read. The bytes may be of the persons involved in the event or reaction of prominent personalities on that event.

Anchor-Package: The culmination of all the above stages is the package. In this, there are voice overs, appropriate visuals, relevant bytes and PTC. The package is supposed to present a full picture of the event.

So far as writing the news scripts of the above stages is concerned, the basic underlying principles remain the same. You must have read about the inverted pyramid style of news writing. Always remember to follow that. It is very important to understand the newsworthiness of the raw information before starting the writing. All news stories should have answers of the 5Ws & 1H. Each of these questions may have several parts which depend on the nature of the news. But you should not try to answer all these questions in the anchor read only. This will depend on the time which you are getting for that news. If you are making an anchor- package, you will have the liberty to answer all the 5Ws & 1H.

6.3 WRITING FOR TELEVISION NEWS

Writing depends on two major things: first, type of medium and second, nature of the content. Here, our medium is television and content is news. Television is an audio-visual medium which requires a certain type of writing suitable to the nature of this medium. In this section, we shall discuss the different principles and rules of television news writing.

6.3.1 Basic Principles

Writing for TV news is different from literary writing. In the case of literature, the writer has the liberty to use words to beautify the subject and concept, but in news you should make your selection of words as simple as possible. In the case of literature, the writer has the liberty to express his/her feelings and narrate the

story accordingly, but in journalistic writing one has to be objective. It is believed that the target audience of TV news is the general people so a news writer, especially TV news writer, must not use the complex and difficult words.

If you see the nature of television as a medium, it is dynamic. The story is flowing continuously. Unlike print, for a TV news viewer, it is quite difficult to stop or go back to the previous content to understand that. The process of understanding should match the speed of content flow. So, simple language is must. A simple principle is that no one should be in the need of a dictionary while consuming the TV news. Always remember the golden rule of news writing i.e. K.I.S.S. - Keep It Short and Simple. And you can keep your news writing short and simple by using the words used in daily conversation amongst us.

Always remember that the primary objective of news writing is to communicate the desired information in simple words so that it can be understood easily. At the same time, it should also be remembered that the news piece should answer the 5W & 1H (Who? What? When? Where? Why? and How?) in the order of their importance. It is not necessary to explain all the aspects of the news equally, but it is a normal practice to emphasise the 'What' aspect first and foremost. After that, according to the nature of the information, you can decide which other aspects (Who or Where or How, etc.) are needed to be explained.

Check Your Progress: 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What is the golden rule of news writing?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) In the news writing which aspect gets the most prominence?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

6.3.2 Fundamental Rules

There are a few fundamental rules of writing which have been laid down to assist in creating effective content for TV news. We shall discuss them one by one:

Write for the eyes and ears of the viewers: Yes, you got it right. A TV news viewer must be hooked in the beginning of the story and therefore the script

should be emphatic enough to garner his/her attention to the TV screen. You should read your script out loud after completing it. Because there are many words which sound alike but have different meanings and these may create confusion for the viewers. Once your script reaches your own ears, you can decide about the changes required in it and improve. For example, words such as 'Quiet' and 'Quite' or 'See' and 'Sea' can create confusion, if not properly supported by visuals. Therefore, it is better to avoid such words. Use short and punchy sentences and refrain from long and complicated sentences.

Write as much as possible in active voice: In a good TV news script, passive voice has no place as the passive voice writing jumbles up the normal sequence of subject, verb and object. Due to this, the viewer's brain has to work more than the normal to understand what is being said in the news. A basic thumb rule is to avoid the use of "by" in a sentence.

Example: The district magistrate has ordered to impose curfew in certain areas of the city. (Active voice)

In certain areas of the city, the curfew has been imposed by the order of the district magistrate. (Passive voice)

Naturally, the sentence said in the active voice uses less words as well as communicates the message easily. So, you should remember this rule that your news script should be 'Active'.

Use present tense as much as possible: TV news should sound like "now." Even the evening news bulletin needs to sound fresh because no one is interested to know about the old and stale news. The natural tendency is to write the news in past tense which should be avoided.

For example: "The Court declared XYZ firm bankrupt in a decision pronounced in the afternoon today. The court also suspended the payments of the jewellery firm according to the bankruptcy law."

But you can write the above sentences in the following manner as well:

"The court declares XYZ firm bankrupt. Today afternoon, the court suspended the payments and declared the jewellery firm bankrupt according to the law of the land."

In this example, you just start the news in present tense for the hook, then shifts to past tense. It is always good to put the sentence in present tense to give it extra punch but remember not to force the present tense into every sentence you write.

Stories should be people-centric: It is a smart idea to weave the stories around people as viewers tend to connect with such stories. If viewers sense that your stories do not directly affect them, they would not show much interest. For example, if any big infrastructure project gets the government approval, do not present it with simple facts and figures. It should be presented as a news item which is going to impact the lives of the people where the project will be based.

You can start your story with sentences like "Now you can cover the distance between Delhi and Agra in less than four hours. The State government has given its nod for a new expressway between these two cities."

By merely presenting the information in people-friendly way, you can evoke the viewers' interest in your story multiple times. Therefore, it is advised to all the news scriptwriters to study press releases and raw information carefully before writing the story.

P to G Style: There are mainly two styles of the news script which are followed all over the world. The first one is P to G i.e. particular to general. In this style, the script starts with a case study of any person who represents the larger community which is affected by the event being discussed. Normally the first voice over (VO) of the script talks about the case study and in further VO, the script tells us the details of the story. The purpose here is to make a connect with the viewers. As we have mentioned above that stories should be people-centric, this P to G style endorses this theory. Remember that wherever human emotions are involved in the news script, it has a greater chance to leave an impact on the viewers.

P-P-F Style: The second style of news script writing is P-P-F, i.e. Present-Past-Future. It implies that the initial VO of the story should talk about the main news (present), the middle VO should talk about the background of the news (past) and at the end the VO talks about possible impact of the news (future). This style of writing is considered to present the story with all the aspects of the news and hence, it is very popular. An example of such script is given in this Unit in later section.

Use action verbs in your story: In news writing, you cannot do much to the subject or object of your sentences, but you can use action verbs to make the story more interesting. These words give urgency to the story and thus create more interest among the viewers.

For example, use of "is, are, was, were, etc." weakens the impact of the story. "Residents started shouting" sounds much better and impactful than "Residents are shouting."

Be careful with facts and figures: We all know that mathematical numbers are hard to understand for many and especially when these are stuffed in a news story. So always think twice before using too many numbers in your script. Try to make your point clear with rounded or approximate numbers.

Consider this sentence, "The company's profit was Rs.11,470,543, which fell to Rs.5,695,765 a year later."

Now read this, "The company's profit was about eleven and-a-half million rupees, which fell to about half of that the next year."

Which one gives you the better understanding? The second one. Yes, in the second sentence, the viewer gets the point which you want to make and he or she need not to go through many digits. Similarly, if you present numbers as something simple and meaningful information for viewers, the news piece will have better connect. You can understand it with following example:

Sentence- 1: "The car company has raised rates up to 3 percent." Sentence – 2: "The car prices will be hiked up to thirty thousand."

In the second sentence, numbers have been presented as simple and more meaningful information and thus it has added capacity to connect with the viewers.

Try to draw viewers' attention towards screen: Your words should be catchy enough to get the attention of the passive viewers to the television screen. Sometimes, you can restrain yourself from giving too much details and just leave the viewers with a little suspense.

Consider this sentence, "The Khans of Bollywood - Shah Rukh and Salman met and hugged each other."

Now read this, "What happens when King Khan and Bhai of Bollywood meet, let us watch."

In the second sentence, you are forcing the viewers to watch the television screen as you are not telling them what the two celebrities did. The mention of these two celebrities is enough to grab the viewers' attention. You can use this style in a soft news.

Present your story as something special: Do not forget that this is the era of competition and TV news channels are no exception. They have to compete with many other news channels which may show the same story which you are going to present. So, what will make your story more interesting? The ability to present your story as something different and superior. These days you must have heard the use of words "exclusive", "never before", "first time on television". It is to show your promptness and dedication towards the viewers. But apart from this, you can structure your sentence in such a way that it shows your dedication and promptness.

Example: -

"When the education minister said there was no money for mid-day meals in the schools, we decided to dig for answers." A sentence like this shows that you are serious about finding the truth.

"We are the only channel with exclusive visuals of the accident that took place at the highway." By using such writing, you can build the perception of a prompt and faster news channel amongst your viewers.

Take the story forward: "The End" caption works for the movies, not for the TV news stories. Remember that the end of your news script should encourage the audience to come back to your channel. They should have the interest to know what will happen next.

Example: -

Consider this sentence, "The union cabinet will take a call on the 'one rank, one pension' scheme in its next meeting."

Now read this, "We will update you about the outcome of the next meeting of union cabinet on the 'one rank, one pension' scheme."

While the first sentence leaves the viewers in suspense, the second generates curiosity as well as reinforces that your reporter will follow the story further. It is always good to promise to your viewers that you will return with updated information. It helps to build a sense of loyalty amongst TV news viewers.

Check Your Progress: 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) When it is said that your news script should be 'active', what does it mean?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) How can you make your script people-centric?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

3) What care should one take while using figures in a news script?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

4) Why is it advisable to write a script which takes the story forward?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

6.3.3 How to Write an Anchor-Package

The Anchor-package has two parts. The first part is the anchor-link or intro of the news. Here you inform your viewers about the main news and give the basic information. You should not infuse too much information in the intro because it may confuse the viewer. You should just include one or two key points in the sentence. Normally, the intro consists of two or three sentences. The second part is the body of the package. Here, the visuals and bytes are used and the complete story is presented for the viewers. There are some VOs (voice over) over which visuals are laid and bytes are inserted between two VOs to move the story forward.

You should start with the best of the visuals you have, and your story should flow naturally. It is ideal to write TV news script according to visuals. An example of the script of anchor-package is given below:

(ANCHOR LINK)

The number of Indians getting EB-5 visas has jumped almost four-fold in the last 2 years. EB-5 visas promise foreigners a faster route to Permanent Residency in the United States of America. According to statistics issued by the US Department of State, at least 585 EB-5 visas were issued to Indians during the 12-month period ending September 2018. India is just behind China and Vietnam in getting the green card through this route.

PACKAGE

VO 1- *United States of America or USA has been always a preferred living destination for rich Indians. That is why it is not surprising that in the last couple of years, the tendency to get the US citizenship by making investment there has surged. (GFX IN) According to the data released by US Department of State, 585 EB-5 visas were issued to the Indian citizens during the 12-month period ending September 2018. This number was mere 174 in the 12-month period ending September 2017. When compared with the same period ending September 2016, the number of 2018 is almost times, as in 2016 the US Government has issued only 149 EB-5 visas to Indians. (GFX OUT) But what is the reason behind the renewed interest of rich Indians in getting US green card?*

Byte- Rohit Pawar, MD, Bridge Overseas, Mumbai

(By September 2019, the applications for getting EB-5 visas can be increased to 1000. For the last 3 years, this number has seen only an upward growth and this trend is expected to grow further. The real estate community of the country has shown more interest in this as they want to take its benefit for securing the future of their children.)

VO 2- *EB-5 visa promises a green card, if the applicant invests a minimum one-time stipulated amount of 5 lakh US dollars in certain specified areas. At the same time, the investment amount should be enough to provide full-time employment to at least 10 persons there. This rule allows the person making investment to have green cards for two people. Wealthy Indians consider EB-5 visas a good and easy route to secure their future.*

Byte- Mohit Pate, EB-5 Visa Applicant, Mumbai

(We can do business in USA as we are doing in India. But there we can get good higher education for our children as well as social security for us. We can spend our life comfortably there.)

VO 3- *In USA, a total of 10,000 EB-5 visas can be issued to foreigners every year, but no country is allowed more than 7 percent of it. It means that no country will be issued more than 700 EB-5 visas per year. The time taken to get the Permanent Residential status approval is normally 18 to 24 months. The number of Indian applicants currently rank behind China and Vietnam only. And it seems that the rich Indians are ready to wait for this period, or perhaps longer, for becoming green card holders. In Mumbai, XYZ (imaginary name of the reporter) reporting for ABC (imaginary name of the news channel).*

In the above script, you can see that the scriptwriter has presented a trend amongst rich Indians to settle in America. This is written in explanatory nature. From the anchor links, it becomes clear that the content of the story will revolve around the increasing numbers of rich Indians who want to get green card. In the first VO, the numbers are given, and the instructions are also provided to insert and remove graphics (GFX) plate in the package. It helps the video editor to understand from where graphics plate will be inserted and where will it end. Similarly, the transcriptions of byte are also written in the script, so that the VO artist as well as the video editor of the package have full understanding of the story.

In the last VO, the reporter has signed off by mentioning his name. The idea is to register his presence at the place from where he has filed the report. It gives the viewers a feel that the information provided are genuine, original and first hand. Earlier, PTCs (piece to camera) were used to do the same thing but nowadays very few PTCs are being seen in news packages. If you know how to write anchor-package, you can write any script required for different stages of the news.

6.3.4 Writing News Feature and Documentary

Apart from script of a package, TV news writing also includes news features and documentaries. These are longer formats of news content and different in their approaches. You can consider them as the next levels of script writing (for the news content). We are going to discuss these formats briefly here.

News Feature: Writing for news feature is different from hard news scripts. Normally the feature writer has the liberty to show his/her writing skills and creativity. It is built around a news point and it contains those elements which can attract the viewers. As feature writing is more a show of skill, it does not follow any set pattern. Each feature writer can develop his/her own style. Moreover, the style may differ from subject to subject. But there are some points which should be kept in mind while writing the news feature scripts.

Exploring the angles of the story: Before writing, it is imperative to find out all the possible angles of the story. But at the same time, you can not include all the angles of the issue in a single story because it will become too long. So you will require to choose a couple of angles which you find more appropriate than others and around which you would like to narrate the story.

Proper research about the story: You must research properly about the subject which is the basis of your script. Research may include talking to the people having expertise in the subject, sourcing as much information about it as possible and trying to find any previous feature story on the same subject by any other news organisation. This will help you to structure your script.

Writing script according to the mood of the story: You should remember that being a feature story, it has not to be written necessarily in the inverted pyramid style. Here you are telling a story to the viewer and your goal is to give them a real feel of the subject. You must stick to the theme and mood of the story in your writing. There is no need to describe those things which are not relevant to the story. You can add colour, drama and punch in the story but these should fit in your theme.

Documentary: Documentary is also a longer format. New York Film Academy defines documentary as something which is fascinating and which captures the brilliance of humanity when executed thoroughly. A documentary is a result of very hard work and it demands a lot of time, energy and resource to be mobilised. A good documentary is written skilfully, catches people's attention and touches their feelings and communicates efficiently. A documentary is much more and much different than a news report but just like the news, your documentary should be able to connect with the viewers. New York Film Academy says, "Documentaries are real, with real people and dealing with real issues that are powerful and hit us at our core. Let your writing reflect those deep, moving messages and capture your audience emotionally." Therefore, before writing documentary script, you should have a clear and precise idea of your subject. You must have the understanding of how the story will be delivered. In fact, before writing a documentary script, you must complete your research, collect the required data and shoot the interviews, etc. Once you have all the materials, you can filter the required ones and start writing the script of the documentary. You must remember that writing is an art and you need to practice regularly in order to improve your artistry. Also, every artist has his/her unique style and creativity, similarly, every news writer has his/her own style of expression. You should study the writing styles of others but try not to copy anyone but to develop your own style.

Activity – 1

Write a TV news script in the P-P-F format with the following raw information and discuss the script with your counsellor and classmates during counselling sessions.

The Prime Minister's signature Ujjwala Scheme came in for rich praise in a new WHO pollution report. The report nevertheless estimated that 9 out of 10 people around the world breathe air containing high levels of pollutants. An estimated 7 million people every year die of diseases caused by ambient (outdoor) and household air pollution. "While the latest data show ambient air pollution levels are still dangerously high in most parts of the world, they also show some positive progress. Countries are taking measures to tackle and reduce air pollution from particulate matter. For example, in just two years, India's Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana Scheme has provided some 37 million women living below the poverty line with free LPG connections to support them to switch to clean household energy use," the report said. Launched by the PM on May 1, 2016 in Ballia, Uttar Pradesh, Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY) aims to safeguard the health of women and children. The BPL families are given LPG connections with a support of Rs 1600 per connection in the next three years.

The report estimated that ambient air pollution alone caused some 4.2 million deaths in 2016, while household air pollution from cooking with polluting fuels caused an estimated 3.8 million deaths. A total of 7 million people die every year from exposure to fine particles in polluted air that penetrate deep into the lungs and cardiovascular system, causing diseases including stroke, heart disease, lung cancer, chronic obstructive pulmonary diseases and respiratory infections, including pneumonia, the report said. Particles less than 2.5 micrometres in diameter (PM2.5) are referred to as "fine" particles and pose the greatest health risks. Because of their small size, fine particles can lodge deeply into the lungs.

Commenting on the findings of the Report, WHO Director General Dr Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said: “Air pollution threatens us all, but the poorest and most marginalized people bear the brunt of the burden. It is unacceptable that over 3 billion people – most of them women and children – are still breathing deadly smoke every day from using polluting stoves and fuels in their homes. If we do not take urgent action on air pollution, we will never come close to achieving sustainable development.”

The report shows that more than 90% of air pollution-related deaths occur in low- and middle-income countries, mainly in Asia and Africa, followed by low- and middle-income countries of the Eastern Mediterranean Region, Europe and the Americas. “Many of the world’s megacities exceed WHO’s guideline levels for air quality by more than 5 times, representing a major risk to people’s health. We are seeing an acceleration of political interest in this global public health challenge. The increase in cities recording air pollution data reflects a commitment to air quality assessment and monitoring. Most of this increase has occurred in high-income countries, but we hope to see a similar scale-up of monitoring efforts worldwide,” says Dr Maria Neira, Director of the Department of Public Health, Social and Environmental.

Determinants of Health at WHO. The highest ambient air pollution levels are in the Eastern Mediterranean Region and in South-East Asia, with annual mean levels often exceeding more than 5 times WHO limits, followed by low and middle-income cities in Africa and the Western Pacific.

(Indian Express Report on 2nd May, 2018)

Check Your Progress: 3

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What is the difference between writing for hard news and a news feature in television?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

6.4 LET US SUM UP

As television is one of the most popular and powerful media of mass communication, you need to be doubly sure before telecasting any news item. Every news item must follow the basic principle of answering 5Ws & 1H. Remember the KISS (Keep It Short and Simple) formula for script writing for TV news.

And, because of its audio-visual nature, in TV news writing, you need to focus not only on words but on visuals as well. It must be kept in mind that the words and visuals match as well as complement each other while presenting on screen.

People-centric news scripts generate more interest amongst viewers. The aim of the script writer is to present the news in such a way that people feel connected and benefitted by that. Also, the story should move forward so that the viewers can develop a sense of loyalty towards the broadcaster. TV news writing also includes feature as well as documentary writing. The approach of writing these scripts may be different but the basics of script writing remain the same.

6.5 KEY WORDS

Anchor Link: The content spoken by the news anchor.

Byte A short and relevant part of interview (on camera) of a person related to the news story. 'Byte' and 'Bite' are used interchangeably.

GFX: GFX stands for graphics.

Voice Over: An audio which describes and explains the visuals.

6.6 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

Barnas, F. (2018). *Broadcast news writing, reporting, and producing*. New York: Routledge.

Block, M. (2011). *Writing broadcast news: Shorter, sharper, stronger: A professional handbook*. Washington, DC: CQ Press.

6.7 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) The golden rule of news writing is K.I.S.S. It stands for Keep it short and simple. It means that while writing news, the scriptwriter should use easy to understand words which are part of our daily conversations. The sentences should be short so that the target audience can understand them easily.
- 2) It is expected from any news item that it will answer the 5Ws & 1H i.e. (Who? What? Where? When? Why? and How?). But the most important aspect is 'What' and in most cases, the news answers the 'What' aspect first. It is because the viewers will be interested to know what happened before going into the details of any event.

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) The news script should be written in active voice sentences as much as possible. The sentences written in passive voice are longer and give unnecessary twist to the structure of the sentence which is not suitable for television.

To make the news script people-centric, it is necessary that the same should be presented with facts or information which are going to impact the lives of people. Mere presentation of press releases or raw information in a dry manner will not be attractive for viewers. Viewers will be interested to know whether the aired news has anything to do with their daily lives.

- 2) It is always advisable to refrain oneself from using too many mathematical figures in news scripts as they may take more time to be understood. So, if there is a need to use figures in a script, it should be made as simple as possible. Scriptwriter should try to connect those figures with some daily life activities so that the viewers can relate to them and their interest is retained.
- 3) If a script takes the story forward, it shows that the channel is following the story and will update the viewers as and when the further information are made available. It helps to build a loyal viewer base for the channel.

Check Your Progress 3

- 1) In hard news script, the writer cannot take any liberty to beautify the script, but in a news feature the writer has the option to present the script in an attractive way. Feature writing does not necessarily follow the pattern set for the hard news. A feature is normally made on soft news or when the hard news needs to be presented along with different perspectives.



UNIT 7 CONTENT PRODUCTION FOR RADIO & TV

Structure

- 7.0 Introduction
- 7.1 Learning Outcomes
- 7.2 Content Production for Radio
 - 7.2.1 News Formats
 - 7.2.2 News Production (News Bulletins)
- 7.3 Content Production for Television
 - 7.3.1 Production for Television
 - 7.3.2 Producing News Programmes
 - 7.3.3 Production Team
- 7.4 Let Us Sum Up
- 7.5 References and Further Readings
- 7.6 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

7.0 INTRODUCTION

Content production can easily be described as the most important aspect of the radio and television industry. Unless the quality of the produced content is good, you cannot expect your listeners or viewers to be glued to your radio or TV channel. In order to leave an impact on the audience, the content must be interesting, informative, attractive and unique, and these qualities can be ensured at the production level. Therefore, it is quite essential to have a qualified and creative production team. We all know that radio and television channels carry a variety of content from entertainment to education, but since this block is focused on radio and TV journalism, in this Unit we shall limit our discussion only to the content related to news and current affairs.

7.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After going through the unit, you should be able to:

- describe the various radio news and current affairs formats;
- discuss the process of radio news production;
- describe the basic principles and stages of television content production;
- explain the production process of different news programmes; and
- describe the role of different people involved in the content production in a TV news channel.

7.2 CONTENT PRODUCTION FOR RADIO

Radio content is a broader term and it covers various areas from education to entertainment. In this unit we shall limit our discussion only to news and current affairs. News gathering, news production and news dissemination are the three

major functions of a radio news room. All three are interdependent and one cannot be performed without the support of the other. Of these, news production calls for special skills in deciding what the news is, writing a story and presenting it using the radio medium.

7.2.1 News Formats

The radio news can be presented in different formats of varied duration having their own special characteristics. Some of them are as follows:

News Bulletin: In the realm of news, radio's strength emanates from its capacity to inform current affairs instantly. There are many formats to cover current affairs. A radio news bulletin is one such very prominent format with different presentation styles depending on the length and requirements of the bulletin. A two minute or five minute bulletin will not have headlines because these bulletins are already brief. These will present the news crisply in the order of priority. A ten minute bulletin will, however, start with about 4-5 headlines followed by detailed news and end also with a repetition of the headlines. It may have one break in the middle of the bulletin restating the identity of the originating organization. This will help those who may join later to identify the station/organization broadcasting the news. It can include sound bites or voice dispatches of correspondents. A 15 minute bulletin can however carry several sound bites, voice dispatches and even short news capsules made using both sound bites and dispatches or vox pops. Live dispatches by correspondents from news location also find a place in such bulletins. These can have two breaks after every five minutes with a crisp short sentence announcing what more is to come in the bulletin.

Talk: As news bulletins give a very brief account of a news event, there is a need to go for other formats to give the details that listeners would like to know. This news analysis is done employing different radio programme formats namely talks (as commentaries), reviews, panel discussions, interviews etc. AIR has two daily programmes 'Samayiki' and 'Spotlight', which provide in depth news analysis using mostly the formats of talks and interviews. Then, there are two weekly programmes 'Charcha Ka Vishay Hai' and 'Current Affairs' in the discussion format.

Radio Newsreel: Radio Newsreel is a format embellished with many sound bites and actuality inserts. The linking script is kept very short. Appropriate sound inputs are interwoven into this brief script. This renders the news presentation more lively and interesting compared to simple reading of a text. Voice dispatches of correspondents are also used in Radio Newsreel. However, Radio Newsreel is always pre-recorded and edited for broadcast unlike the news bulletins, which are presented live.

Phone in Programme: It is an interactive programme in which an anchor and one or more experts discuss a subject and the listeners can have live participation in the programme by calling some designated numbers. This provides two-way communication and therefore is very interesting and effective format. Market Mantra is one such popular programme of AIR giving information about stock market behaviour and tips from experts for better investment options.

Radio Bridge: Radio Bridge programmes are produced with elaborate networking in place. This format is very effective in informing and analyzing major events

such as counting of elections or budget presentation, when inputs and reactions from many parts of the country need to be woven into the programme. In this format also, an anchor with or without a panel of experts sits in the main studio connected to anchor persons with their respective panels of experts at radio stations at various locations along with correspondents deployed at various places where action is happening like, in the case of elections, counting centres, headquarters of political parties, etc. On election counting days, this kind of programme can continue for several hours capturing the election verdict scenario by reporting minute to minute position and incorporating analysis and reactions from experts, leaders of political parties, common people, etc. This interactive programme brings in people from various locations on one platform.

Features and Documentaries: Radio features and documentaries are employed for detailed reporting and analysis of news based stories. These give elaborate treatment to the subject with music, vox pops, experts' inputs, interviews, actuality sounds etc. in one programme. Traditionally, features and documentaries were of half an hour duration. But now, shorter and crisper versions are preferred.

7.2.2 News Production (News Bulletins)

The production of radio news bulletins involves many activities. In this section, we shall discuss the production process of a radio news bulletin.

How to Compile a Radio News Bulletin

Compilation is a very important aspect of creating a news bulletin. The editor should know about the listeners and what are their areas of interest, because, s/he has to select the news items keeping this in mind. The editor's first task is to rewrite the stories in a radiogenic language, keeping in mind the length of the bulletin and relevance to the listeners. Once this job is over, the stories are arranged in the descending order of interest and importance. This process is called bunching of the items. The most important and interesting item should come at the top of the bulletin and the least important at the bottom. The idea is to retain the attention of the listener for as long as possible. Normally sports and weather items are covered at the end of the bulletin if these items do not make big news on that day. The situation will change in circumstances such as cyclone hitting some areas or a grand victory for Indian sportsmen or some other major sports news. After the bulletin is finalized, the headlines are drafted usually of one crisp sentence each. National bulletins cover national, international and regional news. Regional bulletins focus on regional stories.

Length and structure of News Bulletin

- Structure – headlines followed by body of the bulletin
- Length of the bulletins is normally 10 minutes with one break.
- But there are also 5 minutes bulletins without headlines.
- There is another category of two-minutes of headlines only.
- Longest bulletins could go for 15 minutes with two breaks.
- Normally about 600 words are covered in 5 minutes bulletin.
- Bulletins are typed in 14 font and triple space so that, if needed, last minute corrections and insertions can be easily made.

Selection of News

Select the news items of importance as well as interest to your listeners. On an average about 80 thousand words are received by the New Room on a usual day. You need at the most about 1500 words even for your lengthiest 15 minute bulletin. Therefore, selecting the important items of interest to your listeners and rejecting unwanted items, passages and words are one of the main jobs of an editor.

Basic Principles of Writing a News Story for Radio

It is also prudent to remember that during one bulletin the listeners can hear a news item only once. Unlike newspaper readers, they cannot go back and listen to a part again. Further, a newspaper reader's eyes can grasp a lot of details while reading. Therefore, print journalists can write long sentences and cram a lot of information and statistics in it. Newspaper pieces are written for the eyes. But radio scripts are written for the ears. You get only one chance to reach the listeners and they hear only one word at a time. So the writing style for radio has to differ substantially from the style used for print reporting. Now, with the progression of technology, more actuality sound based bulletins and programmes are produced to make it sound more real. Thus, new formats of news have emerged.

Accuracy, Balance, Brevity and Clarity are the basic principles of news writing for both radio and television.

Accuracy: You have to find out whether the news is credible (true) and accurate. If accuracy is absent, you lose your credibility, which then is very hard to regain. There have been many instances where incorrect information, sometimes of a momentous nature, has been mistakenly disseminated by the media. The added problem with the broadcast media is the fact that here dissemination is instantaneous and thus it becomes very difficult to retract and mitigate the adverse fall out of the error. In addition to carelessness, these mistakes happen when each channel or agency wants to beat all others in 'breaking' the news first. In this terrible rush, sometimes not enough cross checking of the facts is done with other sources before putting the story on air. The best way to ensure accuracy is by cross checking with different sources.

Balance: Another principle in writing is maintaining balance. If a story carries only a one-sided version, it will be lopsided. The truth will not come out in its entirety.

Brevity: There is a famous saying that brevity is the soul of wit. This holds true for the news items also. All unnecessary and irrelevant details have to be cut out retaining only what is essential. Chiseling and honing are essential but some pertinent and interesting details have to be provided to maintain the attention of the listeners.

Clarity: One may have the best news story. But, it may not be understood if clarity of expression is lost. There are several aspects to be kept in mind to achieve clarity of thought and expression while producing news based programmes or let us say any programme for radio.

While writing for radio news, some of the principles to be followed are:

- i) **Spoken language:** Radio news script should be in spoken language. It should be as if you are telling the story to someone. The best way to do this is to read aloud the story as you write or type the script. This will avoid

tongue twisting words. We use simple words in spoken language. For instance, you won't say - "I am contemplating to go to market". You are more likely to say that "I am planning to go to the market".

- ii) **Avoid complicated sentences:** Use simple sentences and present tense. Relative pronouns like who, whom, whose, which, that etc. will complicate your sentence. Avoid complex and compound sentences and complicated clauses. Avoid superfluous adjectives and superlatives.
- iii) **Writing for ear and not for eye:** Radio script requires writing for the ear and not for the eye. A newspaper reader can catch a lot of details and many words in one glance while reading. S/he can also go back in case of any doubt. A radio listener cannot do this. Therefore loading too many words into a sentence will make it difficult to follow and understand.
- iv) **Rounding off large numbers:** Large numbers should be rounded off to the nearest round figure. It will make these easy to grasp. Besides, the rupee or any other currency name should come at the end of the number **and** not before. Because that is how we speak. We don't say - give me Rs.5. We say- give me five rupees. Rs.105343.53 can be said as over one lakh rupees. See, how easier it now to understand!
- v) **Short span of attention:** Avoid information overload. Listeners have short span of attention. They cannot absorb a great deal at one time. Avoid cramming too many details into one item.
- vi) **Others:** Few other principles are - Don't overload with information; write in present tense or present perfect tense to convey immediacy; and use active verbs.

Process of Editing News and Preparing News Cast

Rewriting the story for radio news, writing in inverted pyramid format, writing the lead, writing the rest of the story, writing the headlines, attribution including the dateline are important principles of editing the news. How do we go about it?

- Select the lead news story.
- Also select other stories to be included in the rest of the bulletin.
- Redraft the stories to suit the need of the bulletin without altering any fact.
- Use sound inputs – voice casts, sound bites, capsules or wraparounds, expert comments and live inputs.

Inverted Pyramid Format: Write the story in inverted pyramid format. The most important information should be on top and the rest of the information should follow in the descending order of importance. It is just opposite to the composition in a literary form. In literary writing, the story is slowly built up and usually the climax comes at the end. Not so with news writing. It is actually in the reverse order. The climax will be at the top and the other details are given in the decreasing order of priority. This style makes it easier to edit the story even at the last minute. If the item seems too long, the last one or two sentences can be removed without materially affecting the story if it is written in the inverted form. Even if all the other sentences are edited out except the first sentence, it will still indicate what the news is about. That is the advantage of writing in the inverted pyramid form.

Lead/Intro

The opening lines of the story, called **Lead** by the Americans and **Intro** by the British, must catch the attention of listeners. Leads have to be short and brief to catch listener's ears. Lead sets the tone and tenor for the subsequent narrative of the story. It must entice the listeners to listen further. A great story with a poor lead can drive away listeners from hearing the news. In the earlier days, journalists used to sincerely follow the five Ws - who, what, when, where & why - to write a lead. If even two or three of these are properly followed, the lead or intro would be good.

Cut out non-news leads: Lead should contain important and substantial news. 'Today is Independence Day', 'A workshop will be held this afternoon to discuss climate change' - these kind of leads will not be very effective without any substantial news.

Hard or soft lead: A hard lead comes out with the crux of the story immediately. Example: *Opposition candidate Ibrahim Mohamed Solih defeats Abdulla Yameen in the Maldives presidential poll.* A soft lead does not straightaway give news. It prepares the listener to wait for the news to follow. Example: *Yameen concedes defeat in the Maldives presidential poll; Mohammed Ibrahim triumphs.*

Suspense and delayed lead: Here the key information is not revealed at the beginning of the story. The real news may come in the second sentence or even later. Example:

"It was water, water everywhere. But the global search for Commander Abhilash Tomy did not go in vain. French Shipping vessel OSIRIS located him at last in the vastness of South Indian Ocean today."

The lead of the story should present something new. It cannot start saying "As reported earlier....."

Normally avoid negative lead. If the listeners miss the first word '**no or not**', they will get it all wrong. Example: *No increase in the Income Tax rates, says the Finance Minister.*

Refresh the lead: Refresh the lead every two or three hours. If a train accident is reported, subsequent stories should give different leads like information on rescue and relief operations. If the arrival of a foreign dignitary is reported, subsequent stories should lead with details of his/her activities since then.

Techniques for writing Headlines

Headlines are very important in a radio news bulletin. Following facts explain more about headline writing for radio news:

- Headlines come at the top of the bulletin.
- Generally comprise a single sentence for each of the story mentioned in the headlines.
- They work as teaser making listeners continue listening.
- Headlines should not reveal too much or too little.
- If these reveals too much, the listener need not listen to the details in the bulletin.

- If these reveal too little, interest of the listeners to listen to the bulletin may not be aroused.
- Chiseling and honing are must for writing a good headline.
- Headlines are repeated at the end of the bulletin to enable those joining late to be apprised of the salient details of that bulletin.

An example:

News item: *“India has accelerated to buy drones from Israel that can be armed, Defence sources said, allowing military to carry out strikes with less risk to personnel”*

The headline could be: **India’s plan to buy Israeli drones is put on fast track.**

Check Your Progress: 1

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) Which programme formats help analyse news?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) What are the advantages of Radio Newsreel?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

7.3 CONTENT PRODUCTION FOR TELEVISION

In this section, we shall discuss the content production for television in detail. Television news channels broadcast news and current affairs content in various formats such as news bulletins, debate-discussions, interviews, news documentaries, etc. but here we shall focus more on news bulletins.

7.3.1 Production for Television

Television is an audio-visual medium that incorporates visual and audio elements. A number of activities are required for production of television content like-recording or creation of visual elements (videos, photographs and graphics), recording of the audio elements, script writing, audio-visual editing, etc. In this section, we shall discuss these activities in detail.

Basic Principles

It is always said that content is king, whether it is about news or other genres. Unless you produce quality television content for your viewers, you cannot expect to succeed in the long run. So far as news content for television is concerned, they may be of various types and that again depends upon the nature of the news programmes. For example, a typical TV news channel produces news bulletins, debate-discussion shows, documentaries on current affairs, feature shows, interviews, etc. While the basic principles of television content creation always remain the same, you need to work with a different approach for different formats.

Every TV and radio production, whether it is a news bulletin, debate-discussion or a documentary, must go through the three fundamental stages before its completion. These stages are:

- 1) Pre-production
- 2) Production
- 3) Post-production

Many a times, these stages may take very long (sometimes even weeks or months) to reach the desired level of completion. It also depends on the type, duration, complication and intricacy of the content that needs to be created. But, a daily news bulletin or talk show will have to be completed in a few hours or a single day by following these stages. However, a good and efficient production team will usually execute each of these three phases at least to some degree before finalising the product. For example, if you have to produce a live show, you require a lot of planning for the initial two phases but you do not have the liberty to go through the third phase. Though, the 'live' editing with the help of switchers may be considered as post-production stage but it goes on simultaneously along with production.

Three Stages of Television Production

The whole process of television production may be categorized mainly in three stages. These stages are the following:

i) Pre-production

Pre-production covers all the activities conducted before the actual production. From conceptualisation to all other preparations for actual production fall in this stage only. Even though some people consider Conceptualisation or Formulation as a separate stage, it is generally considered to be a part of pre-production only. The process of pre-production actually starts with Conceptualisation.

Conceptualisation: As the name suggests, conceptualisation involves most of the thinking work and is done on paper. In this stage, you start with generating ideas for your desired content. When you have certain ideas ready, you and your teammates discuss about the feasibility, effectiveness and workability of those ideas. The length of this process will depend on the format as well as nature of the show. If you are working on a daily news bulletin, you just think about the selection of the news pieces according to their importance and their treatment in your bulletin. But if you are working on a talk show, you may require thinking about the relevant issues to be discussed, availability of the experts on the issue, the audience to be

present in the studio, etc. If needed, you need to seek some additional information through internet research, old interviews or talking to some domain experts. Once your idea is finalized, you start working on it. During this phase only, you can also decide whether your content will be telecast 'live' or recorded. You can then proceed to the next step of content creation.

Pre-production also includes arrangement of the desired support staff who will be required during the content creation. These staff may include script writers, editors, studio directors, production assistants, camerapersons, audio operators, lighting directors, graphics designers, etc. It is clear from the above description that the number of persons involved in pre-production stage of a programme will vary according to the nature of the content.

If you have decided to telecast your programme 'live', you need to check the technical aspects well in advance. If you are going to create content which can be recorded and broadcast later, things will be in better control as you can make changes if things do not go as expected.

ii) **Production**

The production stage can be called the real tangible work on the ground. It involves most of the crew members and can be exciting as well as exhausting. This stage sees your idea or concept converting into a product. Many creative activities i.e. video recording, audio recording, performance etc. are done in this phase only. As far as writing is concerned, in some cases, it is part of pre-production and in some cases it may be a part of production stage. Just take few examples, if we talk about fiction (film production, serials, etc.), script writing is part of pre-production. In production we execute the script, but in the case of documentary films, pre-shoot scripts are written again after shooting because documentary is recording of reality. During shoot (production) we may get many new ideas, facts and angles which need to be incorporated in the script. So here, final script writing becomes part of the production stage. The same thing is applicable to the news stories also. Scripts of news stories are written after recording of the footages and bytes, so here also writing may be considered as a part of production stage.

If the show is not going 'live', production stage of news programmes may be little relaxed. Various shots are recorded, reviewed and re-recorded according to the requirements of the programme. But in a 'live' show, there is no time for reviewing and re-recording. Your attempt should be to create the content as flawless as it can be. In the case of non-live shows, it is necessary to maintain a log of must have shots and sequences, and any other necessary information that will enable the video editors to locate and identify during post-production. Without this log, your precious hours will be wasted trying to find certain key information or the best shots of the show.

iii) **Post-production Stage**

It is only in the post-production stage that the desired content takes the final shape. As this is the final stage, here the producer gets the opportunity to give the finishing touches to the content. It is also only here that you can expect to get the fruits of all the hard work and long hours put in by the crew. Usually, the non-live programmes take many hours of post-production, but news stories cannot take longer post-production due to the immediacy factor.

The main component of post-production is the editing which is done by video editors. Video editors have to follow the script of the show, but they have liberty to enhance the impact of the show. Therefore, many a times the decisions to select the best shots, to add filler sequences or change the sequence of certain shots are left to them. Sometimes, they need to insert some graphic elements which are created by graphic artists of the channel. These graphic elements may include animations, credits, or other computer-generated contents. Once all the requirements are completed and the editing is done, the programme becomes ready for telecast.

7.3.2 Producing News Programmes

You must remember that production of news programmes is quite different from the other television genres. For TV news programmes, usually the team is fixed and that team remains available to gather and compile the required content. In most of the cases, the production schedule of a news programmes is not more than a single day. Therefore, the environment of TV news production is quite hurried and intense. 'Live' programmes need more care and quick action. Without careful planning and execution, it can go horribly wrong. Now we are going to understand the exact nature and ways of work in a TV news organisation for production of the content.

Producing a News Package

A news package is a special way to present news to the audience. Normally a news package has a story, some real characters and some facts. News reporters spend considerable time in researching stories, collecting visuals, interviewing characters, and then writing the scripts according to the gathered information. All news packages follow a basic structure which makes them easy to understand. These packages may be of various durations but usually packages run from 90 seconds to two minutes in length. In special cases, the duration may be longer as well.

In fact, news packages are considered to be the backbone of any news show. That is why making news package is one of the most important tasks of the reporters and other employees. When the assignment desk of the news channel assigns a particular news story to the reporter, the process of making a news package begins. The reporter needs to follow the news, collect the latest information, visuals (video or stills) and bytes (or interviews) of the concerned parties and then write a script describing the event or issue.

No doubt, TV reporting needs much more than its print counterpart. In order to file a story or report, a TV reporter has to go through a long process. While going for reporting, s/he accompanies a cameraperson. The cameraperson shoots the visuals and reactions of the concerned persons. The responsibility of the reporter is to help him/her in capturing the best visuals and ask the relevant questions to the concerned persons for the news story.

But the responsibility of the TV reporter does not end here. After going back to the office, s/he has to file the report according to the visuals and bytes collected by him/her. Many a times, the reporter may take the help of graphics department, if any information is required to be shown in the form of graphics. When the news report is completed, the producer checks the script filed by the reporter.

When it is cleared by the producer, the reporter has to sit with video editors to edit the final story. Here the script has to be voiceovered by the reporter or voice-over artist. And then visuals, graphics and bytes are laid over the VO (voice-over) to give it a shape of edited package. The edited news stories or packages are then used by the producer for his or her bulletin or show.

The most important thing to note here is that a television reporter has to follow the visuals of the event. This is not required for a print reporter. Moreover, a TV reporter has to be quick as s/he has to deliver the news as soon as possible. The print reporters, however, enjoy the greater time and flexibility. As the newspaper will be printed at night and delivered to the doorstep of the consumer only the next morning, newspaper reporter can file his/her story with comparative ease. But the TV reporter has to be quick and on the run as his/her organization needs to play that news story the same day itself. So, for being a successful TV reporter, pace and accuracy both are the prerequisites.

Producing a News Bulletin

In a typical TV news channel, the person who owns the responsibility of producing a programme is called the producer. The producer of a news bulletin has to produce his/her bulletin before its deadline. If the bulletin has to go 'live', s/he will have to prepare all the contents required for the news bulletin beforehand.

First of all, the producer decides the news stories which are to be included in the bulletin. After that, s/he decides the order of the news stories in the bulletin and prepares a run-order or rundown. In the rundown, it is mentioned before every news story that what will be its treatment and how much time is to be given. In fact, mere seeing a well-prepared run-order, you can visualise the look of the bulletin to be aired. That is why rundown is also called bulletin on paper.

Once the producer makes the rundown of a bulletin, s/he distributes the responsibility of producing the content among his/her associates and other teammates. S/he has to see whether any script is to be written, which news stories are already made in the system and which are to arrive later, what graphics elements are required, etc. In a 'live' news bulletin, the producer has to make provisions for 'breaking news' scenario also, therefore, s/he needs to make rundown in such a way that the important and must have elements get enough time to be aired. This decision needs dynamism and quick thinking. A good producer always remains alert about the flow of news.

Once elements of the rundown are completed, the producer is ready to go live with the show. As the timing of any news bulletin is fixed, the producer needs to ensure that enough news materials are ready with him/her so that the duration of the bulletin does not fall short. When the bulletin is being rolled, the producer needs to prompt the anchor of the show regularly about the elements being added or dropped from the news show. Usually, the news anchor reads an introduction (or anchor link) 'live', then the pre-recorded story is shown. As the show is 'live', there is no scope for post-production, unless there is repeat telecast of the bulletin. If there are some errors which need to be fixed, it should be done before the repeat telecast of the same show.

Structure of a news bulletin: Generally news bulletins start with headlines. Most important story of the day is given priority and is given more time than the other news items. It depends on the discretion of the producer that how much

time s/ he wants to give to a particular news story. If s/he wants to present a news item in big way, s/he demands from the assignment team to arrange for some domain experts who can elaborate the importance and various aspects of the news. For example, an item of national or international interest is considered most important. Normally soft stories find place at the end of the bulletin.

7.3.3 Production Team

Many people contribute to the production of news content in a television news channel. These include persons involved in the assignment team who are responsible for finding potential news stories. In a news channel, the assignment editors assign specific stories to reporters to pursue. But as far as production is concerned, the role of the television producer is greater. S/he is a person who oversees all aspects of the television programme. Some producers take more of an executive role, in that they conceive new programmes and after approval from the superior authority, they hand it over to the show or bulletin producers. These show or bulletin producers are more involved with the day-to-day workings, participating in activities such as script writing, making rundown and producing bulletin and other news shows.

Apart from the producers, the role of various technical crew members cannot be ignored in a news channel set up. These persons work diligently and contribute to the smooth running of the news bulletin and other shows. Without their help, you cannot expect your work to be completed. They include the studio director, set designer, graphics artist, cameraperson, vision mixer, audio engineer, video editor and others.

Check Your Progress: 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What is the role of producer in a TV news channel?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) What are visuals in the context of television news channels?

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

7.4 LET US SUM UP

Content (news) production for a radio or television channel is an exhausting task and it demands efforts of many people. Whatever is the format and structure of the news programme, there is a need to plan in advance and prepare accordingly. From conceptualisation to the execution, there are many stages of production which involve a lot of people from editorial and technical side to complete the job. So, basically a news bulletin or any other news programme format is product of a team work. Usually, in a television news channel, the role of producer becomes very important as s/he is the person who handles all major aspects of the content production.

7.5 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

McLeish, R., & Link, J. (2015). Radio production. CRC Press.

Schroeder, A. (2009). Writing and producing television news: from newsroom to air. New York: Oxford University Press.

7.6 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

- 1) Commentaries, reviews, panel discussions, interviews etc.
- 2) It is predominantly a sound based programme that provides sound bites of people and reports from correspondents. Radio Newsreel is always pre-recorded and edited for broadcast unlike the news bulletins, which are presented live.

Check Your Progress 2

- 1) The role of television producer is of larger importance. S/he is a person who oversees all aspects of a television programme. Some producers take more of an executive role, in that they conceive new programmes and after approval from the superior authority, they hand it over to the show or bulletin producers. These show or bulletin producers are more involved with the day-to-day workings, participating in activities such as script writing, making rundown and producing bulletin and other news shows.
- 2) The term visuals should not be mistaken by only videographed content. Graphics (maps, charts, diagrams, and illustrations), animations and still photographs can also be used as visuals.

UNIT 8 PRESENTATION TECHNIQUES FOR RADIO & TV

Structure

- 8.0 Introduction
- 8.1 Learning Outcomes
- 8.2 Presentation Technique for Radio
 - 8.2.1 Categories of Presenters
 - 8.2.2 Requirements for a Presenter
 - 8.2.3 Script for Presentation
 - 8.2.4 Do's and Don'ts While Presenting a Programme
- 8.3 Presentation Technique for TV
 - 8.3.1 Television News Presenters: Essential Qualities
 - 8.3.2 Writing Anchor Script
 - 8.3.3 Challenges for a TV News Anchor
- 8.4 Let Us Sum Up
- 8.5 References and Further Readings
- 8.6 Check Your Progress: Possible Answers

8.0 INTRODUCTION

In the previous three units of this block on Radio and TV Journalism you learnt about the unique attributes of radio and television mediums, script writing, and content production. In this last unit of the block we shall try to understand the skills required to present radio and television programmes in a manner so as to make it interesting, effective and successful in the process of communication. You will agree that any programme will fail to make the desired impact, despite having good content and a well written script, if it is not presented attractively. In this unit we shall examine the attributes of a good presenter and learn how to work on a script before presenting it over the microphone or camera.

8.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After going through this unit you should be able to:

- understand the importance of presentation in radio and TV;
- identify the categories of presenters in radio;
- discuss the attributes of a good radio and television presenter; and
- improve your presentation skills for radio and television.

8.2 PRESENTATION TECHNIQUE FOR RADIO

Overall impact of a radio programme depends on the script, production quality and also the way of presentation. You may argue that presentation and packaging is a part of production quality and that is subsumed into it. However, being an aural medium, the selection of words for the script is as important as the rendering of it i.e. presentation. Therefore, it is imperative that the producers of radio

programmes should learn about the presentation techniques equally well because that can make or mar the entire production.

In our day to day communication and conversation, facial expressions and body gestures add a lot of meaning to the spoken words, thereby helping in understanding and adding more impact to the message. But a radio presenter does not have the visual support of such facial expressions and body movements during communication, as listeners cannot see him/her, and therefore one has to put more efforts and creativity into the art of rendering the speech to make it memorable and impactful.

For our understanding, presentation broadly means packaging of the content in a radio programme and technique means art, method or procedure for attractive and effective presentation. Radio being a medium of sound, radio presenters should possess a pleasant, good quality voice, command over the language/dialect of broadcast, good diction and flawless pronunciation as well as confidence and flow in speaking. They should have what is called 'the gift of the gab', meaning 'the ability to speak with eloquence and fluency'.

8.2.1 Categories of Presenters

Presenters are, in effect, representatives of the broadcasting organisations and act as links between the organisation and listeners. While the internal hierarchy and programme production team of the organisation remain in the background, a listener identifies with the presenters and establishes a rapport with them. Presenter's success lies in compelling the listener to listen that programme. It can be easily seen that a presenter's role becomes crucial in establishing and then maintaining a vibrant rapport with the unseen listener. Radio presenters can be classified into various categories which may sometime appear overlapping but subtle variations give rise to various forms. Some of the prominent categories of Radio Presenters are discussed below.

Announcer/Compere

Announcers have been the traditional identity of Radio Stations, particularly in All India Radio. Sometimes by just listening to a voice you can say which AIR station you are tuned to.

The broad general category where all presenters have to start is the announcer/compere category. Announcers generally announce all of the important information relating to the public, including programme details, time, commercials, public interest messages and sometimes weather reports.

An announcer essentially introduces the broadcast of a particular programme/item with all its necessary details. These details vary as per the nature and genre of the programme. For instance, if it is a talk, then these details include the subject or the title of the talk, the name of the talker, i.e. the person delivering the talk and a very short and crisp introduction of the talker (to justify why this particular individual was chosen to deliver the talk on this particular subject). If it is an interview, then the announcer has to tell the listeners about the subject or theme, the name of the expert or interviewee (again with a short introduction to justify his selection) and also the name and a shorter introduction of the interviewer. If it is a discussion, then there ought to be more than two participants and a moderator who need to be introduced along with the subject. Other genres

like poetry recitation, short stories, features and documentaries, radio drama, magazines, commentaries, etc.; almost all have a title and a cast of performers as well as producers, editors, voice over artists and so on, to be announced by the announcer.

As has been mentioned, announcers also need strong writing skills, because they normally write their own material. In addition, the announcer should be able to improvise all or some part of the show. It is crucial that an announcer has the temperament to work under tight deadlines. Sometimes some of the announcements have some peculiar names of people, places, procedures etc. These announcements need to be pre-written and properly rehearsed in advance before going for broadcast.

News Reader

The news is an important segment of programming. You are aware that a News Reader reads the script of a bulletin prepared by the News Editor and team. However, in some radio stations, just like television news anchors, news readers are also journalists. In such cases they perform a dual role of journalist cum presenter. The first and foremost quality that a News Reader should have is good voice which is steady but not shrill or jarring. S/he should be fluent in reading with perfect diction, pronunciation, pace, pauses and pitch. The reading should reflect a sense of confidence which comes with a good understanding of the news content included in the bulletin. S/he should have adequate knowledge of the events and happenings within the country and around the world. An aptitude for journalism would be a great asset in this regard. In any emergency or crisis situation, s/he should remain unruffled and be able to present even unrehearsed, handwritten news items flawlessly.

The basic difference between news reading and presentation of other programmes is that news is presented in a formal, fact of the matter and objective style in which emotions are avoided.

Narrator/Voiceover Artist

Features and documentaries are among the most popular radio formats. In these programmes the linking narration is the backbone which ties up different channels of content together. When you listen to a radio feature the first thing that attracts you is the voice of its narrator. Depending on the demands of the theme of a feature or documentary, an artist is chosen to do the narration so that s/he can enhance the effect of the programme with his/her unique voice quality and narration style suited for that particular programme.

Voiceover is a term used mainly in television production. In a TV programme or documentary when you do not see the speaker on the screen and only his/her voice is used for the programme, it is known as voiceover. Voiceover artists these days have a huge role in dubbing dramatic programmes or films from one language to the other. Cartoon and animation programmes also utilise their talent and skills in a big way.

Radio Jockey

You might have come across terms like DJ, VJ and RJ. These terms basically define the role of a person in an event, activity or broadcast. DJ or Disc Jockey presents and plays film or pop music on popular demand usually in a public

place like a restaurant, club, etc. or during a celebratory event like a wedding. The term comes from the days when primarily discs or records were played for music. VJ or Video Jockey is also an announcer who presents music videos as well as live performances mostly on private commercial television stations.

Commentator

The word 'Commentator' immediately brings to mind sports commentators. Around the world, sports commentary has been one of the most popular forms of radio programming. In India, we have had many iconic sports commentators like Jasdev Singh, Sushil Doshi, Murli Manohar Manjul, Suresh Saraiya, etc. Many people feel that one of the most important factors contributing to the popularity of Cricket in India has been its radio commentary on AIR stations. Sports commentary has not been confined to Cricket alone, Jasdev Singh himself was a legendary Hockey commentator.

The art and craft of radio commentary does not limit itself to just sports commentary. There can be many kinds of non-sports commentators also, specialising in some particular field, activity or event. If you have heard the Republic Day Parade Radio Commentary from Rajpath in New Delhi describing all the action as it happens, you would know how the commentators create an exact word and sound picture of the parade for the people who are listening to the commentary.

Anchor/Host

Anchors are radio programme hosts who put together different items seamlessly using sound bites and narratives. Anchors usually conduct and moderate live broadcasts with provision for real time listeners' participation through phone calls, SMS, e-mails, etc. along with the participation and interaction with subject matter specialists, experts and opinion makers normally present in the studio. Anchoring is arguably perhaps the most complex of the range of jobs a presenter can undertake. During the special radio shows and phone-in programmes, anchors handle various tasks such as dial outs also.

Stock Characters

To attract and retain audience through appropriate use of dramatic elements, many a times

comperes perform as Stock Characters, i.e. they adopt the names and mannerisms of such nature that over a period of time, these characters become instantly recognisable to members of a the target audience group. Because of this, use of stock characters in skits and family serials is very popular.

8.2.2 Requirements for a Presenter

Senior and experienced broadcasters have enumerated from time to time, the attributes of a good radio presenter. If we collate those with some other important aspects we may summarise these as follows:

- For being a good radio presenter, a pleasant and well-modulated voice, good sense of timing, rich vocabulary, correct pronunciation and command over the language are basic requirements.

- Radio is a very personal and intimate medium. It requires talking to your audience on a one-to-one basis. The presenter must talk to the audience in a very personal and intimate tone. Speak as if you are talking to a friend - an equal and intelligent person, never talk at or talk down to your listeners. Therefore, always imagine a friend's face on the microphone and then talk to him or her. Radio is for talking to a person. Even if lakhs of people are listening to you, they are doing so individually and not collectively as a crowd. Hence, always speak as if you are addressing one person.
- The first and foremost responsibility of those speaking into the microphone is to communicate in an easily intelligible way. Therefore, the radio performer needs to first develop and then further refine his/her speaking skills – articulation, enunciation, intonation, pronunciation, variety and naturalness. That is why education to enhance communication skills has become an increasingly important factor.
- The language used should be colloquial, spoken language which we use in our day to day conversations. It should not be offensive or vulgar. Good taste and decency should always be maintained.
- Build your own style. Understand your own personality and try to be yourself. Don't imitate or copy anyone else. People would like it if you are honest to yourself and speak with conviction and self-belief.
- As far as possible, try to maintain an equal distance from the microphone. Getting too close or moving too far away will affect the level of your voice. Similarly, you also need to watch your angle to the microphone when you are speaking. Sometimes people tend to spread all pages of their script on a table and start reading. That results in continuous change in the angle of your mouth to the microphone which may adversely affect the quality of your voice and delivery.
- While reading take a single sheet of paper in your hand, keep it behind the microphone and after finishing the page, put it down gently. Normally the news readers fix each single page on a cardboard and pick these one after the other. That would be the best practice. However, if that is not possible, then fold the corners of the pages of your script and lift them one by one and after reading, put these gently on the table. Softly picking up and dropping of a sheet makes less noise than dragging it on the table, which creates a paper rustling sound. The microphones installed in a broadcast studio are very sensitive and the rustling noise picked up by them is very irritating as well as distracting.
- Sitting posture is also important when you are broadcasting or recording a script. If the chair is not comfortable; it is too high or too low; it will affect the quality of your delivery. If you are sitting in a slouching position, you may not be able to speak with the desired intensity. Presentation is a performance and it has to be taken in that spirit. That means you have to be agile and alert while speaking.
- Good sense of humour will always enhance your performance as a presenter. Communication made in a very serious manner is not always desirable. Try to have a smile and warmth in your tone as you speak into the microphone.

You should be aware that you have only the medium of sound to convey your message, thoughts, information and emotions. You can't use actions, gestures or a visible smile to support your communication. So, try to put everything into your voice, which is required as per the script or the nature of the programme. Read it with interest excitement, humour and above all a personal touch. Remember, a smile can be heard.

8.2.3 Script for Presentation

While writing a script for Radio presentation the following things must be kept in mind:

- The language used should be the spoken language, which is conversational and colloquial. Choose simple and descriptive words and use simple and short sentences.
- Avoid negative constructions and passive voice.
- Avoid homophones (similar sounding words that are spelt differently – such as 'aloud' and 'allowed') and alliterations as these create confusion of sound and meaning.
- While using numbers - especially multi-digit figures, it is advisable to round them off and use with words like approximately, around, more than etc.
- For ease of reading before the microphone, use good quality of paper. The copy should preferably be cleanly typed, with double line spacing and enough margins on both sides. Write or print only on one side of the sheet. It is also advisable to use a bigger font size and divide the matter into paragraphs. Do not split the sentence on to two pages. Always complete a sentence on the same page.
- Incorporate all the necessary instructions in the script.
- Avoid abbreviations and use of words that are unfamiliar.
- The best way to improve your script as well as rendering is to read it aloud. When you read it aloud to yourself, you are more likely to identify and make the desired changes in the script and also improve your presentation.

8.2.4 Do's and Don'ts While Presenting a Programme

We have already discussed the many do's and don'ts of radio presentation in previous sections. Here are a few more.

- Do not tap or strike the table with your legs or any other object as it creates a disturbing sound. Often we do it as a habit or nervousness without even realizing.
- Participants should see the cues (signals) given by the Recordist or Producer. S/he must understand these properly and act accordingly.
- Use a participatory style of presentation and use a friendly tone. Imagine that you are in a group discussion talking to a small group of people. Avoid lecturing as if to a large audience.
- Keep track of the time and properly wind up the session by thanking experts and participants.

- Announce the theme, date and the time of the next session.
- Anchor should summarise the content in the end, preferably point wise.
- During the broadcast if there is no interaction with the listeners, anchor should be ready with some questions to make the session interactive and lively.
- Welcome the listeners and participants in the beginning of the programme and thank them at the end.
- Introduce the theme and resource persons for the session in progress.
- Announce telephone, fax numbers and email ids. Help the listeners from time to time as to how they should ask questions, giving advice such as first they should mention their names and the places from where they are calling. They should be advised to ask their question slowly and clearly to make sure it has been understood by the expert.
- Never use a pinned up or stapled script. Before starting the recording or broadcast, remove the staples of the script and use one page at a time.

Check Your Progress: 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What are the essential qualities of a Radio Presenter?

.....

.....

.....

2) What are the categories of radio presenters?

.....

.....

.....

8.3 PRESENTATION TECHNIQUE FOR TV

Television news channels, by and large, revamp themselves from time to time in order to establish a stronger visual connect with their viewers. They understand the value of overall presentation as it gives the brand better recall value and credibility.

News presenters or anchors are an integral part of the overall packaging and presentation of a television news channel. They are the mediators between a channel and the viewers. Anchors try to maintain the continuity between different segments of a programme or a news bulletin. The news presenter's knowledge, look, personality and presentation style influence public perception about the news item. Hence, news channel anchors represent the channel and also function as conduit of credibility. Television anchoring is not just about reading the lines from a teleprompter. Here the most important factors are speech, knowledge, body language, voice modulation and command over spoken language. A good anchor is expected to strike a balance in all these territories while anchoring.

The task of presenting a programme is challenging one because anchors are expected to reinvent themselves as per the evolving media scenario and changing requirements of their channel and viewers. The anchor is responsible for not only providing information, but also to ensure that a programme or news bulletin is delivered in a credible and authentic manner. Today the ever-changing media landscape keeps the news channels on their toes while providing them with a plethora of options - to revamp, innovate and introduce new presentation techniques.

8.3.1 Television News Presenters: Essential Qualities

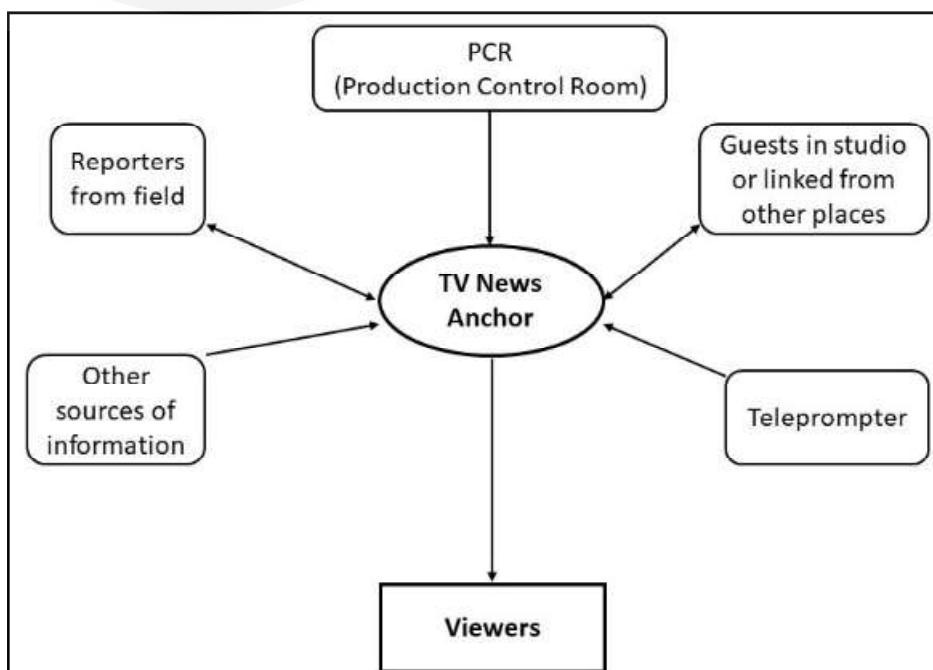
Reading the news from a teleprompter and anchoring a news bulletin may sound easy, but it is more cumbersome than it seems. In last two decades, there has been tremendous change in the media scenario in India due to launching of dozens of news channels in English, Hindi and various other Indian languages. It has increased the competition and resulted in the requirement of skilled and innovative news presenters. A good anchor must possess the following qualities:

Knowledge of Different Fields

Knowledge of different fields is an essential requirement for a successful news anchor. A good understanding of different issues and the ability to organize and retain new information is the critical aspect of anchoring a news bulletin. A news anchor must have insight into current national and international issues. S/he should have sufficient knowledge of what s/he is sharing with the viewers. At times the producer of news bulletin may make some errors in the spellings or names. In such cases, if the anchor is ignorant of basic facts and figures, s/he will not be able to correct the information. An anchor must be well versed in current affairs, politics, geography, history, other related areas, and should have the ability to put all information in the required perspective for viewers.

Ability of Multitasking

An anchor must have the ability to multi task or handle multiple activities at the same time. You can understand the engagements of a News Presenter with the help of following image (Figure:1).



The ability to take and follow the producer's instructions via an earpiece while searching information from news websites and social media, listen to what other reporters are sharing and panellists are adding and monitor incoming video simultaneously is very important.

Objectivity

Ideally, a professional news anchor must take an unbiased or neutral stand on issues covered by the channel. S/he should be quite balanced and impartial in his/ her approach towards them. An anchor should try to not come under any kind of pressure or influence that can limit his/her professional autonomy. Moreover, s/he should not allow even his/her personal feelings of hatred or liking for anyone/ anything to be exhibited while anchoring.

Command over Language

A good command over language, proper pronunciation and neutralized accent are the basic pre-requisites to be an anchor. There are, however, different regional accents associated with Hindi and English languages in India. If you want to be an anchor, then it is necessary for you to be linguistically neutral and versatile.

Dressing Sense

Television news anchors have to carefully choose the kind of dresses, accessories and jewellery that they wear on screen because they are expected to look decent and presentable while anchoring in front of the camera. The camera tends to pick up some colours and patterns better than others. Therefore, for both men and women, knowing what not to wear is just as important as knowing what to wear. This is because most often, if you wear anything distracting or flashy on TV, people will remember only that and not what you say.

You should also be careful about the colour of your outfit in front of the camera. Contrasting colour scheme and cool colours are considered more suitable. Anchors are generally advised to avoid bright white to the extent possible. Shirts in solid-colours like blue, beige, and off-white are considered as best options though. And if you wear a bright white shirt or blouse in front of the camera, then you can balance it by wearing a dark jacket over it. You should avoid fabrics with complicated patterns, checks and close stripes. However, pastel shirts work well on television. Very shiny or glossy fabrics that reflect light into the camera, should also be avoided.

Anchors generally prefer to wear clothes of natural fabrics that can breathe easily under the warm studio lights. While one may also love wearing loose clothes, but wearing them on air can make it more difficult for the microphone to stay in place, and it is bothersome to constantly adjust it. On the other hand, anything too tight can look inappropriate. Anchors are also expected to avoid jewellery that sparkles, shines or dangles in the light or those that rattle such as multiple bracelets or long necklaces as they tend to causing distracting noise while brushing against the microphone. News anchors are expected to use accessories with subtle patterns. Male anchors are also expected to avoid neckties with tightly designed patterns and shiny fabrics as they are not suitable in front of the camera.

Capability of Sight Reading

Sight reading is when you do not have the time to read or rehearse the script. As an anchor, you must get used to sudden changes in the rundown and breaking

news. This is not what most people feel comfortable with doing but anchors have to face this situation regularly. Sight reading is about two things only: confidence and the ability to pick up lines quickly. Sight reading tests the anchor's ability to grasp the script and his/her improvisation skills. It also tests how well an anchor performs under pressure. A good sight reader is able to communicate with fluency and clarity without any rehearsal.

Skills to Use Teleprompter

The teleprompter plays an important role in reducing the stress associated with anchoring. The main advantage of using the teleprompter is that it allows you to look directly into the camera lens while reading the script. The script is reflected on a monitor and that monitor is placed directly in front of the camera lens. It allows an anchor to be comfortable in front of the camera. However, you have to keep the following things in mind while using a teleprompter:

- Speed of the text that is scrolling down is controlled by the teleprompter operator. So, you do not have to worry that you will run out of words. But nowadays, the teleprompter is operated by the news anchors in most of the news channels. Therefore, you should learn to maintain a proper speed of your text on teleprompter.
- You are advised to keep the current read words in the middle of the teleprompter screen.
- You should try to read the script at least once before the bulletin or show.
- You need to practice pacing with the teleprompter.
- Use conversational tone and talk to the camera as if you are talking to your viewers.
- Try to keep your body posture relaxed because if it is in a rigid position and only your eyes are moving to read the text, your viewers will come to know about it and it reduces your credibility. Do not slouch but be relaxed.
- You should set the font size according to your comfort. Remember that if the font is bigger, the number of words on the TP screen will be fewer and you will not be able to look at the whole /or a large part of the sentence.

Voice Modulation

Voice Modulation is done to change the different properties of your voice to make the presentation more effective. It is change in stress, pitch, loudness and an inflection of the voice which gives your voice mood, meaning and makes it sound more attractive. The most important responsibility of an anchor is to avoid monotonous pace in order to make every news story sound different. Pauses at right intervals and adding expression to every sentence prevent a monotone. Also, an anchor must change the tone of his/her voice before moving on to the next story.

Acquaintance with Journalistic Ethics and Laws

An anchor should follow a code of journalistic ethics. Ethical responsibility demands that inaccurate information, information that endangers public safety, words that can create panic and traumatize the victims should be avoided. It also requires an anchor to be free from any sort of inclinations or associations that

instigate him/her to compromise on honesty and thus eventually affecting reliability.

Ethical challenges have been heightened by the 24x7 news scenario. News channels get considerably less time to verify or cross check the information. Hence, under the pressure to boast being the first channel to give particular breaking news to viewers, sometimes anchors are asked to go on air with unconfirmed information which may be misleading and inaccurate. Anchors must also be aware of the consequences and legal implications which may generate trouble for them as well as their channels.

After knowing the essential qualities of a television news anchor, you can practice in different ways to improve your capabilities. As a student, reading the news stories aloud from a newspaper can be the first step towards practicing. Aspiring anchors can practice by recording their voice on various applications available on phone. You should work on your reading style to make it more conversational.

8.3.2 Writing Anchor Script

Once a rundown has been completed or sometimes even before that, the news bulletin producer can start writing anchor scripts of individual news stories. It is also known as anchor link or “The Readers”. It is like intro of the report and presented by anchor. You should not squeeze too much information into one or two sentences if it is an anchor link of a news package. If you are writing an anchor link, keep the following things in your mind:

- You should keep sentences simple and short as it is easier to digest and share idea of the story by using simple and clear information. Difficult words should be written phonetically, and producers should ensure that they point them out in advance.
- You should be careful with numbers. It is ideal to take big numbers and write them in words to make it easier for anchors to read them in a flow. For example, instead of “the government promises to generate 800000 employment opportunities in next five years,” the anchor script should be written, “the government promises to generate 8 lakh employment opportunities in next five years.”
- You should avoid passive voice sentences and use conversational tone. Anchor script should be written in active voice and should appear as if the anchor is speaking to the viewers. Using conversational tone is very important to establish connect with the viewers. It should not appear as if the anchor is just reading from the teleprompter.
- You should try to use compelling words in anchor links. The viewers should be hooked to watch the whole report or segment after hearing the anchor link.
- Share main idea of the news report. Try to identify specific W questions that you should provide answers to in the readers/anchor links.
- Try to introduce the name of the reporter while writing anchor link of a news report. If s/he is reporting live in an area, recognize that so and so is reporting live and specify name in the script as well if it is an exclusive report as the reporter deserves the credit.

8.3.3 Challenges for a TV News Anchor

The challenges faced by news anchors have increased because of the 24-hour news cycle. This news scenario leads to rushed stories, inaccurate reports, incomplete information and sometimes even misleading content. Hence, the anchors have to go straight on air with information that may not be accurate and which may make them more susceptible to action under libel laws. Some other challenges faced by news anchors on a day-to-day basis are as follows:

Learn to maintain composure under crisis: Anchors have to keep calm during a time of crisis. Sometimes the crisis may be due to a bad and horrible news story or at other times, it may involve some on-air technical problem.

Last minute changes: Anchors are always required to be ready for a complete change in rundown and script at a moment's notice. If a breaking news story comes during the on-air bulletin, the producer may take the decision to make sudden changes in the rundown and insert it into news bulletin.

Long work hours: a news anchor cannot afford to have a regular 9 to 5 type of job. Plans have to be cancelled on a moment's notice if suddenly a big breaking news comes along during a bulletin. Their working hours and timings are fixed as per the requirement of the news channel they are working for.

Public criticism: A television news anchor has to develop a thick skin to realize that you cannot please everybody. Some viewers may criticize the anchors for their hair, dresses, style of speaking, having political bias, or being too aggressive. News anchors have to accept it as a part of their job.

Artificial Intelligence supported robot anchors: AI (Artificial Intelligence) supported robot news anchors have been experimented in few countries. Like many other fields, artificial intelligence may pose new challenges to the human news anchors. So, in future, anchors need to be more creative and continuous innovations will be required to keep human anchors relevant for the television news industry.

Check Your Progress: 2

Note: 1) Use the space below for writing your answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this unit.

1) What are the important points one should keep in mind while writing script for anchors?

.....

.....

.....

.....

2) List any five essential qualities of a good television news anchor.

.....

.....

.....

8.4 LET US SUM UP

In this Unit, we have discussed various aspects of radio and television presentation. It is hoped that this discussion will help aspiring anchors in understanding the dynamics of anchoring and will also help them to hone their anchoring skills. Radio and television anchoring demands a lot of hard work, sincerity, perseverance and knowledge. Knowledge about different fields and current affairs, command over language, ability of multitasking, knowledge of journalistic ethics and laws and voice modulation are a few essential qualities required for a good radio or television news presenter.

8.5 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

A blog by Ms. Rupa Jha from BBC Hindi

Bakshi, R. (2019). Let's talk on-air. Puffin.

Geller, V. (2012). *Beyond Powerful Radio*, 2nd Edition. Focal Press. Stewart, P. (2010). *Essential radio skills*. London: A & C Black.

Kalra, R.(2012), *The ABC of News Anchoring*, Noida, Pearson education India.

Malati, M. (2003). *Presentation Techniques* . In *PGDAPP-MJM-002*. Delhi: IGNOU.

Reardon N. (2006), *On Camera: how to report anchor and interview*, London, Focal Press.

Robert T. and Cindy Malone, (2004), *Broadcast journalism handbook: A television news survival guide*, Lanham, Rowman and Littlefield

Trewin, J. (2003). *Presenting on TV and Radio*. Oxford: Focal Press.

Verma, S. (2009). *Programme Presentation*. In *CCR-BJM-002*. Delhi: IGNOU.

8.6 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress - 1

- 1) A radio presenter should have a good command over language, along with a well-modulated voice, correct pronunciation and good vocabulary. S/he needs to build a personal relationship with listeners while being able to multi- task. A presenter should be able to communicate clearly and thus should be articulate, with clear enunciation, and intonation. S/he should use everyday language for the programmes.
- 2) Radio presenters are divided into several categories according to the shows they host. These are: Announcer/Compere, News Reader, Narrator/Voiceover Artist, Radio Jockey, Commentator, Anchor/Host and Stock Characters.

Check Your Progress - 2

- 1) Keep sentences short, write big numbers in words, use conversational language, cover only the gist of the report, try to introduce the name of the reporter, etc.
- 2) Knowledge of different fields, ability of multitasking, command over language, capability of Sight Reading and skill to use teleprompter.